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THE RISING NEPAL

ALL BE HAPPY, ALL BE WELL

MARTYRS DAY MESSAGES

RSS
Kathmandu, Jan. 30

President Ramchandra Paudel said respect to martyrs would be realised only when the spirit of the constitution and republic were embraced and initiatives were taken for translating aspirations for sustainable peace, good governance, development and prosperity into action.

In a message delivered on the occasion of the Martyr Day, 2080, he stressed the need of honestly playing remarkable roles from their sides to materialise the dream of martyrs.

President Paudel noted that the country has obtained federal democratic republic as a result of the martyrs' devotion. The constitution-envisaged federal democratic republic has set a target of dispensing justice to helpless and income to the disadvantaged with political, economic, social, religious and cultural freedoms.

Similarly, Vice President Ramsahay Prasad Yadav has said that the dedication and sacrifices made by the martyrs should be recalled to pay tribute to them and to raise awareness in the society.

In a message on the occasion of the Martyrs Day today, the Vice President said that political parties, civil society and all others should work with firm commitment to materialize the dreams and aspirations of the martyrs.

Vice President Yadav said that lasting peace, good-governance, development and the aspiration of prosperity should be completed through the achievements of obtained from the martyrs' sacrifices.

The Vice President has recalled that some great souls have taken birth at a certain time of the history and have sacrificed their lives for the country's security, democracy, inclusiveness and identity and added that the martyrs--after their martyrdom--have given the responsibility of safeguarding country's independence, indivisibility, sovereignty and security to the patriots.

In his message, the Vice President has recalled all those known and unknown great martyrs for the sacrifice of their lives for the cause of ending all sorts of discrimination, establishing democracy and federal democratic republican system.

PROBE PANEL ON NCELL SHARES SALE SUBMITS REPORT

RSS
Kathmandu, Jan. 29

A probe committee formed to carry out study regarding the sale and purchase of shares of Ncell, the telecommunication service provider company of private sector, has submitted its report to Prime Minister Pushpa Kamal Dahal 'Prachanda' at Singha Durbar on Monday.

Committee Coordinator, Tanka Mani Sharma Dangal submitted the report in presence of Minister for Communications and Information Technology, Rekha Sharma.

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PHOTO:HARI AIDI/TRN

Women in Mugu district carrying the loads of pine leaves to make compost manure.

54,720 policemen being adjusted in provinces

BY PURUSHOTTAM P. KHATRI
Kathmandu, Jan. 29

Eight years after the promulgation of the new constitution, the government has moved forward with the adjustment of the federal police in the province police offices.

The Ministry of Home Affairs has started preparations to begin police adjustment work within a month.

Last Wednesday, Prime Minister Pushpa Kamal Dahal 'Prachanda' led a discussion on police adjustment, whereupon he instructed to complete the preparation for the adjustment within 15 days.

Along with the directive, Deputy Prime Minister and Minister for Home Affairs Narayan Kaji Shrestha also held separate discussions with Ministers for Internal Affairs of the seven provinces only on Sunday (January 28).

The Ministry of Home Affairs has also stated that internal preparations are being made carefully and speedily.

Since the Federal Police Act has not been enacted, the Ministry of Home Affairs has discussed with the Police Headquarters and prepared the draft of a new Federal Police Act to replace the existing Nepal Police Act-1955.

Joint Secretary and spokesperson for the Ministry of Home Affairs, Narayan Prasad Bhattarai, said that along with the process of issuing the Federal Police Act, the adjustment work is also moving simultaneously.

"The Ministry of Home Affairs is doing homework by prioritising the police adjustment work. The Police Adjustment Act had already been issued in 2020, and the draft of the Federal Police Act has been prepared," he said.

However, many necessary work procedures for the adjustment of police after the introduction of Police Adjustment Act 2020, still need to be legislated, said Bhattarai.

In a public function held last Wednesday, Inspector General of Police Basanta Bahadur Kunwar proposed that the Headquarters is ready and positive for adjustment, but some current provisions should be amended.



IGP Kunwar said that adjustments should be made in such a way that there is not challenge to national security.

According to the sources, the Ministry of Home is also doing preparation to amend the new Police Adjustment and Supervision Act through the new session of the House soon.

After continuous pressure from the provincial governments, the government is going to proceed with the adjustment of the police. However, the ex-police officers said that there is a risk that after the adjustment, political interference in the police may increase, and there may be a clash between the central and provincial police, which may increase security challenges.

Home Ministry moving forward with work of Federal Police Act and adjustment simultaneously

Former AIG Rajendra Singh Bhandari said that adjustment should not be rushed without finalising the issue of structure and authority.

"Right now, questions are being raised about the structure of federalism," he said. "The Federal Police Act has not come yet, so making hasty adjustments at a time like this can have a far-reaching impact on the police organisation."

Former AIG Bigyan Raj Sharma argued that the police should not be taken into adjustment immediately and without issuing necessary work procedures.

According to Sharma, when the adjustment is made, there will be an increase in discord between the police of one province and another, and this will increase the security challenge.

Adjustment number in provinces

The government had already finalised the police posts in the centre and provinces four years ago. Out of total vacancy of 79,541 in Nepal Police, 24,821 will remain in Nepal Police and remaining 54,720 will be adjusted in the seven provinces.

Of the total number being adjusted, 10,717 will be adjusted in Koshi, 9,152 in Madhes, 7,345 in Bagmati, 6,745 in Gandaki, 9,443 in Lumbini, 5,458 in Karnali and 5,911 in Sudur Paschim.

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Educate people about republic, PM tells local level leaders

BY A STAFF REPORTER
Kathmandu, Jan. 29



Prime Minister Prachanda

The constitution has clearly stipulated the rights of marginalised groups such as citizens of Madhes, women, Dalits, and other communities and accorded them due recognition.

Prime Minister Pushpa Kamal Dahal 'Prachanda' has said that local representatives should reach people's doorsteps to educate them about the structure and tenets of the federal democratic republic. He urged the local representatives to pay attention to the matter as public were unable to understand the spirit of the republic.

Speaking at a discussion with the local representatives of Bara and Parsa district on Monday, Prime Minister Prachanda said, "Local representatives should conduct door-to-door campaign to educate people about the republican system. The constitution has clearly stipulated the rights of marginalised groups such as citizens of Madhes, women, Dalits, and other communities and accorded them due recognition. It is the responsibility of the local representatives to make the pubic understand about the constitutional rights."

On the occasion, he said that for the first time in history, millions of farmers victimized by the loan sharks had received justice. Stating that the government was working by forming a high-level commission on loan shark problem, he said, "Thousands of farmers have got justice, tens of thousands will get it soon."

According to a statement issued by the PM's secretariat, Prime Minister Prachanda said that the government was focused on formulating a budget with a collective participation of people and all the political parties.

Stating that works were being carried out with utmost priority for formulating the federal laws as stipulated in the constitution, Prime Minister said that the process had been forwarded for implementing the Police Adjustment Act. He said that the Secondary Education Act was under discussion in the parliament and preparations were being made to table the Federal Civil Service Act in the parliament.

Meanwhile, addressing the 20th establishment day of the Press Centre Nepal and meeting of the National Council, Prime Minister Prachanda said that the policies, programmes and budget were being revolutionized in favour of social justice and socialism. He also urged to build public opinion favouring it.

Stating that in the coming year he would focus on people-centered and participation-oriented policy, programme and budget formulation, he said that 'fundamental reforms' would be achieved by formulating budget in favour of democracy.

He said that the government had taken strong steps against corruption, land mafia and loan sharks. He added that the government had done an important job of including workers in the informal sector, self-employed and foreign workers in the social security fund.

Stating that the Press Centre had an important role in creating and combining ideas, he urged the centre to disseminate government's work and party's campaign amid the people.

After inspection of Special Economic Zone (SEZ) in Jeetpursimara Sub-metropolitan City of Bara on the same day, Prime Minister Prachanda interacted with the local businessmen there. He said that he would create an investment environment by trusting the private sector.

He said, "SEZ project will not be successful without involving the private sector. The government is with the private sector. Ailing industries are in operation, private-government partnership industries should be operated by prioritising economic sector."

ROYAL PALACE MASSACRE WILL BE PROBED

BY A STAFF REPORTER
Kathmandu, Jan. 29

Prime Minister Pushpa Kamal Dahal 'Prachanda' has said that the Royal Palace massacre of 2001 will be investigated.

Talking to journalists at the Simara Airport on Monday afternoon, Prime Minister Prachanda said that the Royal Massacre that occurred on June 1, 2001, at the Narayanhiti Royal Palace, Kathmandu would be investigated.

All Royal family members, including King Birendra and Queen Aishwarya, Prince Nirajan, Princess Shruti, Prince Dhirendra and others were killed in the Narayanhity Palace on the night of June 1, 2001.

PM Prachanda also said that although the federal democratic republic gives everyone freedom, no one has the right to stand against the system and hatch conspiracies.

Dignitaries extol martyrs' contribution to the nation

BY A STAFF REPORTER
Kathmandu, Jan. 30

The nation is marking Martyrs Day 2024 on Tuesday commemorating the martyrs who sacrificed their lives to usher in democracy in the country.

» MARTYRS DAY TODAY

Four big martyrs—Shukra Raj Shastri, Dhrarmabhakta, Dasharath Chand and Gangalal-- got martyrdom in 1941 when they tried to overthrow the family rule of the Ranas and establish democracy in the country. Two of them—Chand and Gangalal were executed by the Rana rulers on Magh 16, 1997 BS (January 30, 1941). Their dream came true a decade later in 1951 when Nepali people overthrew the Ranas and establish democracy. The country has been marking Magh 16 as the Martyrs Day after the establishment of democracy every year.

On the occasion of the Martyrs Day, President Ramchandra Paudel, Vice President Ramsahay Prasad Yadav, former President Bidya Devi Bhandari, Nepali Congress president Sher Bahadur Deuba and other leaders have issued separate messages commemorating the martyrs and recalling their contribution to ensure people's rights, establish democracy and safeguard national sovereignty.

In his message issued today, President Ramchandra Paudel wished that the Martyrs Day might inspire all political parties, people and others to have courage to realise the dreams of those who got martyrdom for the freedom of the Nepali people.

Stating that Nepali people have a constitution written by themselves because of the sacrifices made by the martyrs, the President said that the constitution has envisioned justice for the weak and income for the poor with political, economic, social, religious and cultural freedom.

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International Committee of HoR to visit India

BY A STAFF REPORTER
Kathmandu, Jan. 29

A delegation of the International Relations and Tourism Committee (IRTC) of the House of Representatives is embarking on an eight-day official visit to India from January 30 to February 6.

The 12-member delegation, including eight members of the committee and four staff of the Parliament Secretariat, is visiting the southern neighbour at the invitation of the chairman of the Standing Committee on External Affairs (SCEA) of Indian Federal Parliament. The External Affairs Committee includes 31 members – 21 from the Lower House and 10 from the Upper House.

Chairman of the IRTC, Raj Kishor Yadav, said that the visit is aimed at exchanging experience, knowledge and practice of the parliamentary system as well as discussing Nepal-India relations.

The Nepali parliamentary delegation will hold a meeting with the SCEA and Speaker of the Lower House of the Indian parliament – Lok Sabha – Om Birla. The delegation will discuss about the facilities at the parliament building of India and working styles of the committee including the organisation of meetings.



The visiting delegation is also scheduled to hold separate meeting with External Affairs Minister of India, Dr. S. Jaishankar and Minister for Tourism, G Kishan Reddy.

"We will observe new parliament building of India and will see how it has been designed and managed so that we could find out better ways to manage our new parliament building," said Yadav.

"India is a large democracy. But is stable and there is parliamentary stability despite diverse demographics and political ideologies. There are several things that we need to learn," he added.

He said that students and patients going to India now have to pay fees as SAARC citizens while earlier it was same as for Indians. We will request lawmakers there to take this issue into considerations, said Yadav.

He maintained that economic and business issues will get priority in their deliberations.

Likewise, the Nepali delegation will request Indian Tourism Minister to keep Nepal in the priority list to send their government employees in vacation. About 50 million Indians go out of country as tourists, and government employees get 10 days' casual leave in a calendar year for tourism activities.

Nepali delegation is also scheduled to meet the chief ministers and governors of Maharastra and Uttar Pradesh of India, hold interactions with Nepali diaspora in Mumbai and Delhi. It will make observational tours to Goa and Varanasi. It will also attend a programme at the Embassy of Nepal in New Delhi.

Yadav had already discussed the potential issues of deliberations with the former ambassadors and experts. Meanwhile, the delegation also called on Speaker Devraj Ghimire and Prime Minister Pushpa Kamal Dahal 'Prachanda' on Monday and discussed the proposed visit.



PHOTO: RAJAN RAWAT/TRN

After regular flight disturbances caused by thick fog in Nepalgunj, an aircraft of Summit Air landed at the Simkot Airport in Humla on the seventh day on Monday.

Karnali Province revenue down by 9.5%

BY NAVIN SUBEDI
Surkhet, Jan. 29

It has been found that the internal income of Karnali Province decreased in the last fiscal year as compared to the previous two fiscal years.

According to a regional economic activity study report released by Nepal Rastra Bank, Provincial Office Surkhet, the revenue of the province has decreased by 9.49 per cent in the last fiscal year.

The report showed that in the last fiscal year 2022/23, tax revenue of the province decreased by 9.49 per cent and non-tax revenue by 18.37 per cent compared to the previous fiscal years 2020/21 and 2021/22.

The revenue of Rs. 7.58 billion was collected in the fiscal year 2020/21, and in the fiscal year 2021/22, it increased to Rs. 8.11 billion. However, in the last fiscal year, revenue collection decreased to Rs. 7.56 billion.

Although the recurrent expenditure of the provincial government increased, development budget expenditure declined in the past two years, said the report.

In the fiscal year 2021/22, around Rs. 9.08 billion was spent under the heading of recurrent budget, while in last fiscal year 2022/23, about Rs. 9.48 billion was spent.

Similarly, under the heading of capital budget, the province had spent Rs. 14.74 billion in the fiscal year 2021/22 while it decreased by 13.37 per cent to Rs. 12.77 billion in the last fiscal year 2022/23. In the last fiscal year, Karnali Province government received Rs. 9.38 billion from the federal government towards equalization grants. Similarly, the provincial government had received Rs. 3.39 billion towards conditional grants, Rs. 404 million towards special grants and Rs. 338 million towards supplementary grants in the last fiscal year.

Baburam Koirala, chief of NRB, Karnali Provincial Office, said that although the agricultural sector is functioning to some extent, the economy is shrinking due to the sluggish activities in industries, services and infrastructure.

He said that the contraction in the economy resulted in a decrease in the gross domestic product and the revenue decreased due to the impact on the collection of taxes such as land registration, land reform tax and vehicle taxes collected by the provincial government. He said that it is expected that the economy will return to its normalcy in the coming days.

The NRB concluded that major obstacles such as infrastructure, skilled manpower, lack of raw materials and difficult geographical structure for industrial development in the province have prevented large industries from operating.

Even this year, the production of wood and wooden materials, purifying drinking water and garments has decreased by 25 per cent, 20.73 per cent and 6.98 per cent respectively. However, the production of plastic goods has increased by 160 per cent, milk products by 15.38 per cent and paper and its products by 14.29 per cent, according to the NRB.

211 industries registered in first half of current fiscal year

BY A STAFF REPORTER
Kathmandu, Jan. 29

A total of 211 domestic and foreign industries have been registered during the first six months of the current fiscal year 2023/24. According to the Department of Industry, a total of 211 domestic and foreign industries registered with proposed investment of Rs. 136 billion by mid-January of the current fiscal year.

Even though the number of industries registration increased, the investment proposed by the registered industries has decreased during the review period as compared to same period last year. A total of 145 industries with the proposed investment of Rs. 139 billion had been registered during the first six months of the last fiscal year 2022/23.

Out of 211 registered industries, 32 industries were registered in the month of Poush alone. According to the Department, 28 large industries have been registered during the first six months of the current fiscal year. The Department aimed to register 80 large industries by mid-January of the current fiscal year.

Similarly, by mid-January of the current fiscal year, medium-scale industries have been registered much less than the target. The government had set a target of registering 85 medium-scale industries during that period. However, only 16 industries have been registered.

Similarly, out of the target to register 200 small-scale industries, a total of 167 small-scale industries have been registered by mid-January. In the meantime, about 226 foreign industries with investment commitment of Rs. 22.33 billion were approved during the same period.

Of these, investment made by three large-scale, 12 medium-scale and 211 small industries has been approved. The government has set a target to approve foreign investment of Rs. 38 billion for the current fiscal year 2023/24.

The approval for foreign investment commitment has increased during the review period as foreign investment of Rs. 17.30 billion from 131 industries was approved in the same period last fiscal year.

The registered domestic and foreign industries have committed to provide employment to 13,670 people and the foreign industries which were approved by the Department for investment have committed to provide employment to 12,167 people.

According to the Department, it has approved 6,085 foreign industries with an investment commitment of Rs. 472.3 billion by mid-January 2024. During the review period, one patent and seven designs were registered in the Department. Similarly, 2,538 trademarks have been registered during the first six months of the current fiscal year.

NRNA TO FUND DEVELOPMENT IN SUDURPASCHIM PROVINCE

BY OUR CORRESPONDENT
Dhangadhi, Jan. 29

Minister of Economic Affairs Naresh Kumar Shahi recently discussed the issue of raising investment in Sudurpashchim Province with the delegation of Non-Resident Nepali Association (NRNA).

According to Arjun Kumar Shrestha, the former vice president of NANA, during the discussion, Minister Shahi asked the leaders of NRNA to invest in agriculture and tourism as a matter of priority for the provincial government. Minister Shahi said that it is necessary to improve the living standards of people of Sudurpashchim Province and urged the NRNA to support in this regard.

In the discussion held recently, he asked to think about the possibility of increasing income by investing in water trading and distribution and olive oil production in Sudurpashchim Province. The water here can be exported to big cities of India like Delhi and Lucknow, he said, and olive oil can be taken all over the world.

Minister Shahi said that the investment climate has been improving in the country as the thinking of politicians and employees of Nepal is gradually changing. He said that the government and NRNA should also think in a new way to create hope and give a positive message to the people.

On that occasion, president of NRNA Dr. Badri KC said that there is still a problem in making investments due to laws and regulations, and said that such problems remained both at the federal and provincial level. However, he said that they have given priority to the Sudurpashchim Province for investment purposes.

Stating that they have now symbolically supported Seti, Mahakali Hospital and Baijnath Campus in Kanchanpur, President KC said that after some work is completed in the Securities Board, an investment fund of Rs. 10 billion will be established and after that more work can be done. He said that 5 per cent from the Nepal government and 95 per cent from NRNA will be contributed to this fund.

International Tourism Fair in May

RSS
Kathmandu, Jan. 29

The Nepal International Tourism Fair is going to be held with the aim of publicizing the tourist destinations of Nepal at the international level. The fair is going to be organized on coming May 31 to June 1 to promote the tourism sector of Nepal globally, said Bishnu Pandey of Summit Event and Market Limited, the organizer of the fair.

To make the fair a success, the organizers held a discussion with the presidents and representatives of various organizations related to tourism in the capital on Sunday. On the occasion, Vice President of Nepal Tourism Board, Chandra Prasad Rijal, expressed his belief that the fair will help promote Nepal's tourism sector at the international level.

The fair will have booths representing all the seven provinces of Nepal as well as booths representing foreign countries. There will be more than 125 booths in the fair to be held at Bhrikutimandap exhibition centre, according to the organizers. Stalls from neighbouring India and China as well as from the Maldives, Malaysia, Bangladesh and Thailand will be included in the fair. More than two hundred foreign tourism companies from different countries will participate in the fair.

Karnali's first and only big biogas plant produces energy and organic fertilizer

SUR BAHADUR SINGH
Karnali, Jan. 29

A biogas plant has been set up in Birendranagar of Surkhet district to produce clean energy and organic fertiliser from biodegradable waste.

The KP Commercial Pvt Ltd is the first and the only industry related to environmental sanitation and hygiene in the Karnali Province.

Krishna Prasad Dhakal, a local entrepreneur from Surkhet, established the biogas plant at an investment of Rs. 140 million. The biogas plant of 3,000 cubic metres capacity can process 30 tonnes of waste at its full capacity.

At present, nine tonnes of organic manure, 15,000 litres of liquid manure and 720 kg compressed natural gas (CNG) are being produced by the biogas plant for which the federal government and provincial government provided Rs. 50 million and Rs 17.2 million respectively.

The usage of biogas plant which is based on German technology has contributed to environment protection and minimisation of impact of climate change and job creation thereby aiding in obtaining Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs), said proprietor Dhakal.

He, however, lamented that the organic fertilisers and liquid fertilisers produced from the biogas are accumulated in big quantity in lack of a proper market.

Much to the dismay, the fertilisers also do not fetch handsome prices either, bemoaned Dhakal. Organic fertiliser is being sold at Rs. 30 per kg while the liquid fertiliser is being sold at Rs. 10 or Rs. 12 per litre.

He has not used LPG gas cylinders for cooking for so long since he uses biogas for the same purpose. According to him, he has set up biogas plants in over 4,000 houses so far.

The biogas enterprise he is running has generated jobs for 17 people, said Dhakal who studied biogas in Thailand, Cambodia, Germany and India among others. He claimed that his biogas enterprise has been contributing to the Karnali Province's government's campaign to build an organic Karnali Province.



PHOTO: KAVIN ADHIKARI/TRN

Consumers purchasing vegetables in Kalimati, Kathmandu. It's a vegetable wholesale market.

NEPAL AIRLINES CORPORATION
CONTINUING AIRWORTHINESS MANAGEMENT DEPARTMENT
Tribhuvan International Airport, Kathmandu, Nepal

Invitation for Sealed Quotation

(International Competitive Bidding)
Date of First Publication : 30th January 2024

Nepal Airlines Corporation (NAC), Continuing Airworthiness Management Department Invites Sealed Quotation from PT6A-27 Engine Repair/Overhaul Organization (MROs) for exchange of its two (02) PT6A-27 core engines. The MROs are encouraged to visit the Notice/Announcement page in NAC Website: www.nepalairlines.com.np for detail information and downloading the Sealed Quotation Document.
Completed Sealed Quotation document should reach to the address given below within 15 (Fifteen) days before 17:00 hours local time from the first date of publication of this notice.

For further information, please contact :

Nepal Airlines Corporation
Continuing Airworthiness Management Department,
Tribhuvan International Airport
Kathmandu, Nepal
Tel: +977-1-4113085/4113209, Fax: +977-1-4470768
Email: dir.camd@nac.com.np, dydir.epd@nac.com.np
Website : http:// www.nepalairlines.com.np (Notice/Announcement page)

Government of Nepal
Ministry of Health and Population
Department of Health Services
Management Division
Teku, Kathmandu, Nepal

Invitation for Electronics Bids

Date of publication: **30 January 2024**
Invitation for Bids No: DOHS/G/ICB-5/EDCD/2080-81

1. Department of Health Services Management Division Teku, Kathmandu invites ***electronic*** bids from eligible bidders for the **Procurement of Insecticides for Malaria and Kala-azar Control** under **International Competitive Bidding – Single Stage Two Envelope.**
2. Under the Single Stage, Two Envelope Procedure, Bidders are required to submit simultaneously two separate sealed envelopes, one containing (i) the Technical Bid and the other (ii) the Price Bid, both in turn enclosed in one sealed envelope as per the provision of ITB 23 of the Bidding Document.
3. Eligible Bidders may obtain further information and inspect the bidding documents at the office of Management division Teku Kathmandu or may visit PPMO egp system www.bolpatra.gov.np/egp.
4. The bidder shell chooses to submit their bid electronically may download the bidding documents for e-submission from PPMO's e-GP system www.bolpatra.gov.np/egp. Bidders, submitting their bid electronically, should deposit the cost of bidding document NRs. 3,000.00 in the following Rajaswa (revenue) account as specified below.
   Information to deposit the cost of bidding document in Bank:
   Name of the Bank : Rastriya Banijya Bank, Teku Kathmandu
   Name of the Office : Department of Health Service
   Office Code No. : 370-013-501
   Office Account No. : 1000100200010000
   Revenue Head No. : 14229
5. Electronic bids must be submitted to the office of Management Division Department of Health Services Teku Kathmandu by through PPMO's e-GP system www.bolpatra.gov.np/egp on or before ***13: 00 Hr*** on ***15 March 2024***. Bids received after this deadline will be rejected.
6. The bids will be opened in the presence of Bidders' representatives who choose to attend at ***13:10 Hr 15 March 2024*** at the office of ***Management Division Department of Health Services Meeting Hall***. Bids must be valid for a period of ***90 days*** from the date of bid opening and must be accompanied by a scanned copy of the bid security in pdf format, amounting to a minimum of NRs ***1,30,000.00*** which shall be valid for **30 days** beyond the validity period of the bid **(i.e. 13 July 2024)**
7. If the last date of purchasing and /or submission falls on a government holiday, then the next working day shall be considered as the last date. In such case the validity period of the bid and bid security shall remain the same as specified for the original last date of bid submission.

China working hard to boost ties with Nepal: Vice Minister Sun



PHOTO: AP

Chinese Vice Minister Sun Haiyan, National Assembly Vice Chair Urmila Aryal, and other political leaders at an interaction programme held at Kathmandu.

BY A STAFF REPORTER
Kathmandu, Jan. 29

A visiting delegation led by Chinese Vice Minister Sun Haiyan, representing the International Department of the Communist Party of China, held discussions with the top leaders of the political parties in Nepal.

In the discussion held in Kathmandu on Sunday, Sun Haiyan said that other countries were trying to play the game against Nepal and China.

While interacting with the leaders of various political parties in Kathmandu during her three-day visit to Nepal, Haiyan said, "the political relations between the two countries are good but some other countries do not want to see this."

She said that the reason for visiting Nepal and holding joint consultations with political parties was to improve the relationship between the two countries.

She said that the heads of state of both countries were trying to strengthen the relationship and the signing of the memorandum of agreements had also strengthened the relationship between the two countries.

"This time I held many meetings leading the CPC delegation. Our ambassador has also been working very hard," she said. "We need to work on how to improve Nepal-China relations and cooperate in the new era."

A lot of Chinese tourists have come to Nepal. Nepal must also have felt this, she said. She said that China has invested in the development infrastructure of neighbouring countries. But, the projects being developed in Nepal with Chinese investment are being delayed because of COVID-19 pandemic and other reasons.

Similarly, the Chinese Ambassador to Nepal, Chen Song, said that they were going to improve the relationship between the two countries. The new agreements inked during Prime Minister Pushpa Kamal Dahal Prachanda's visit to China last year have taken the relationship to a new height, he said.

He said that it was necessary to hold consultations on how to further advance the relationship between Nepal and China.

National Assembly Vice Chair Urmila Aryal said that the close engagements and increased communication and cooperation between the two nations have been instrumental in further consolidating relations between Nepal and China.

Nepali Congress leader Dr. Shashank Koirala, UML General Secretary Shankar Pokharel, Maoist Centre General Secretary Dev Gurung and other top leaders of various parties participated in the discussion.

Earlier, Sun called on Prime Minister Prachanda and top leaders of major parties and discussed national, international and bilateral issues.

City Hospital in Lalbandi boosts service

BY JANARJAN KHATRI
Sarlahi, Jan. 29



City Hospital in Lalbandi Municipality has made notable improvements in recent days resulting in the influx of patients seeking treatment. The hospital is now serving approximately 100 patients daily, signalling a positive turn of events.

Half of the patients seeking treatment at the hospital are beneficiaries of health insurance. The recent addition of gynaecologists and obstetricians has led to many safe deliveries, indicating a growing demand for these specialised services.

Dr. Rambishwash Raya, Hospital Chief and Obstetrician, shared that on average, 30 to 35 pregnant women visit the hospital each month for delivery. Plans are underway to introduce surgery services within the next few weeks, with the necessary manpower already in place.

"Needed manpower has been arranged to begin the operation service. We will initiate the service immediately after we acquire the required tools and equipment," said Raya.

Dr. Raya attributed the surge in the number of patients to the inclusion of specialist doctors, with three MBBS doctors currently serving at the hospital. He expressed a commitment to further enhance the hospital's services.

"We have made improvements, including specialists, equipment and infrastructure, and will continue with necessary enhancements," added Raya.

The hospital's upgrade to a City Hospital on January 12 marked a significant development, with the primary health centre transforming into Lalbandi City Hospital.

Surendra Khatiwada, the Coordinator of Lalbandi Municipality Health Branch, revealed that the hospital, now equipped with 15 beds, is in its final stages of completion.

Khatiwada emphasised the imminent launch of operation services related to delivery, pending the procurement of essential equipment such as the operation bed and OT light. "We are ready with skilled manpower to run the operation theatre as soon as we secure the necessary resources," said Khatiwada.

The municipality has recently appointed essential healthcare professionals, including pharmacists and radiologists, indicating a concerted effort to bolster the hospital's capabilities. Lalbandi City Hospital, strategically located along the East-West Highway, aims to evolve into a well-equipped and efficiently organised healthcare centre for the region.

Recognising the challenges faced by patients, particularly from economically disadvantaged backgrounds, who often struggle with high costs in private hospitals, the transformation of City Hospital aims to address these issues.

Patients from neighbouring municipalities are also increasingly seeking medical treatment at Lalbandi City Hospital.

Sankhuwasabha police arrest man on charge of murder

BY OUR CORRESPONDENT
Sankhuwasabha, Jan. 29

District Police Office, Sankhuwasabha, has made public one youth allegedly involved in the murder of a senior citizen in Tumlingtar of Khandbari Municipality-9 of the district.

The police have arrested Akash Rai of zero point of Dharan, Sunsari on the charge of killing 62-year-old Dil Kumari Ghimire on January 20. During the time of the incident, the woman was said to be killed after she was crushed by a tree.

At the time of the incident, it was said that she was crushed to death by a tree. The family of the deceased had also lodged a complaint at the District Police Office saying that the woman died due to natural reasons.

But during the investigation, it was found that Rai committed the murder, Deputy Superintendent of Police Ghana Shyam Shrestha said.

DSP Shrestha said that during the investigation, a bloodstained axe, a mobile phone used by the deceased and a bag carried by the deceased were found in a bush about 150 metres away from the crime scene.

> During the time of the incident, the woman was said to be killed after she was crushed by a tree.

A trained dog was brought from Biratnagar to investigate the incident, said police. Committing the crime, Rai was hiding in Dhankuta, Basantapur and Dharan. DSP Shrestha said that further investigations are being conducted against Rai in the murder charge sheet and robbery.

Rai committed the crime intending to loot the gold she had worn in her ears and neck. He had then sold the gold to Dhana Maya BK of Rupak Jewelry at Rs. 47,000 in Khandbari, and she again sold the bought gold to Dev Bahadur BK of Bibek Jewelry at Rs. 58,000.

Both Dhan Maya and Dev Bahadur were arrested for purchasing gold without any bill.

CIAA FILES CORRUPTION CASES AGAINST THREE

BY A STAFF REPORTER
Kathmandu, Jan. 29

The Commission for the Investigation of Abuse of Authority (CIAA) filed a corruption case at the Special Court against former computer engineer Pradeep Bhattarai working on a contract basis at the Department of Passport, Tripureshwor and Sumitra Sapkota aka Sumi Dhami working at the same department on Sunday. Similarly, it also filed a case against the assistant sub-inspector at the Police Station, Khadaicha in Banke Gajendra Singh Bhandari.

According to the CIAA, defendant Bhattarai had taken a bribe of Rs. 34,000 from service seekers in the name of facilitating the passport-making process and defendant Sapkota was found assisting Bhattarai.

Likewise, a team deployed by the CIAA Butwal Office arrested assistant sub-inspector Bhandari with a bribe of Rs. 8,000 on January 10. Bhandari had taken a bribe from service seekers promising them the release of arrested urea fertiliser and a motorcycle brought for agriculture purpose.

The CIAA demanded fines of Rs. 34,000 for defendants Bhattarai and Sapkota and Rs. 8,000 for defendant Bhandari.

CCTV cameras installed in Ilam's Pathibhara temple

BY OUR CORRESPONDENT
Pashupatinagar, Jan. 29

CCTV cameras have been installed at the Sano Pathibhara temple in Kutidanda of Rong Rural Municipality, Ilam.

In the past a controversy that the money offered to the temple was embezzled had surfaced, prompting the local administration to form a committee to study the case. Now in a bid to strengthen security and maintain transparency,18 CCTV cameras have been installed in and around the temple.

Of the cameras, one has been installed just at the entrance gate of the temple to count the devotees visiting the temple and the remaining 17 cameras have been installed at various parts of the temple premises.

Egha Aryal, Secretary of Pathibhara Conservation and Management Committee, said that the conservation committee of Rong Rural Municipality installed the cameras in the temple.

Secretary Aryal said that the CCTVs have been installed for financial transparency and to ensure security for the devotees and religious tourists visiting the temple.



PHOTO: TRN

A beautiful view of Pathibhara temple Ilam.

After bringing the temple under its ownership, the Rural Municipality has been earning Rs. 1.2 million to Rs. 2 million a month, Aryal said.

Rural Municipality chairman Mani Kumar Syangbo said that work was underway to further manage and organise the temple.

Before this, construction of a separate structure for selling flowers, garlands and other materials has been completed at a cost of Rs. 6.6 million, which was provided by the Koshi Province Government, the Rural Municipality Office and the public.

Snow leopard's lowland foray leaves experts puzzled

BY INDIRA ARYAL
Lalitpur, Jan. 29

In a small enclosure at the Central Zoo in Jawalakhel, Lalitpur, there is a snow leopard. It is the first time the 'mountain ghost' landed in the Zoo, brought there after being rescued from an unusual location.

Normally found in high elevations (2,500 to 5,500 metres), it now remains restricted within a cage, at an altitude of 1,400 metres.

Observing the people in its nervous and confined state within the small cage, the snow leopard might think, "If I were outside, I could hunt them." It might feel uneasy in its small enclosure, perhaps dreaming of hunting in the wild.

It looked tired and aggressive when it was first brought to the Zoo on Wednesday, but by Friday, it started eating a bit of fresh meat and drinking water. The Zoo officials have been giving it antibiotics, painkillers, and vitamins to help it feel better.

It was an exciting moment for journalists, photojournalists, and individuals from various organisations to witness the mountain ghost in captivity in such a low terrain. People were roaming around the captive snow leopard, to have a close look or take pictures with wide-eyed wonder.

This young cub was brought to the zoo from the Koshi Tappu Wildlife Reserve after rescuing it from Charghare of Urlabari Municipality-1 in Morang district on Wednesday.

The Department of National Parks and Wildlife Conservation (DNPWC), in coordination with the National Trust for Nature Conservation (NTNC), organised a press briefing to inform the public about the condition of the rescued snow leopard.

The briefing, was exclusively for media personnel and individuals as well as organisations working on wildlife conservation to take pictures and gather information, but it was not open to the general public.

Finding a snow leopard in the Tarai lowlands, at just 146 meters above sea level, has sparked a lot of discussion among conservationists.

Conservationists have different opinions about the sighting. Some believe that the snow leopard may have explored new areas while looking for new territory after leaving its mother. On the other hand, some suspect that it might have been illegally captured and then escaped from the captive or released when its true identity was revealed.



PHOTO: TRN

Snow leopard at The Central Zoo, Jawalakhel.

Karan Shah, Professor, Tribhuvan University, who has studied snow leopards for a long time, said it is strange to find a snow leopard in low land Tarai. He thinks someone may have captured the leopard when it was young and then let it go when they found it difficult to tame.

"The cub cannot travel and come there naturally as it has to walk for many days by crossing many big and small rivers to reach the area where it was rescued," he expressed.

However, conservation scientist Dr. Madhu Chetri has a different opinion. He explained that young male snow leopards often leave their mothers to find their own territory.

They can travel long distances, and it is possible this one got lost and ended up in Urlabari.

Unfortunately, experts were not able to examine the snow leopard's condition right away after it was rescued. But they are determined to find out how it ended up in the lowlands.

Director General of the Department of National Parks and Wildlife Conservation, Dr. Sindhu Prasad Dhungana, informed that the government, with the help of experts, will look into how the snow leopard ended up in the Tarai region.

The investigation has already started, he added.

He said that they do not plan to keep the snow leopard at the Central Zoo, instead, they intend to release it back into the wild once it fully recovered.

Sharad Chandra Adhikari, Member Secretary of the NTNC, expressed optimism about the snow leopard's speedy recovery so it can be returned to its natural habitat.

He mentioned two possible scenarios -- either the leopard was raised in captivity and escaped, or it lost its way while searching for its territory.

Snow leopards are endangered in Nepal, with their numbers decreasing due to various threats like habitat loss and poaching.

They are usually found in the mountains along the northern border with China, living in protected areas. The government is working hard to protect these beautiful creatures and ensure their survival.

In Nepal, snow leopards are legally protected, but their population is still at risk.

Conservation efforts are crucial to safeguard these majestic animals and their habitat for future generations.

NEWS BRIEF

Smuggled goods seized

Dhalkewar: Dhanusha Police Office has seized goods worth Rs. 750,000 brought illegally from the border by evading taxes. Deputy Superintendent of Police and Spokesperson for the District Police Office Dhanusha Ranjan Aba said that the goods containing onion, clothes, retail shop goods and hardware items were seized during a patrol.

Police have also impounded three motorcycles used to smuggle the goods. The seized goods and motorcycles were taken to the Customs Office, Janakpur, for further legal action.

'Democratic fighter award'

This year's 'democratic fighter award, 2080 BS has been decided to confer on Bhaktapur's former lawmaker and Nepali Congress former district president, Lekhnath Neupane.

The award will be presented to Neupane on coming February 8 amidst a special ceremony at the Office of President, Shital Niwas, according to Nim Kumari Rana Foundation's Chairman Kabir Rana.

(TRN/RSS)

THOUGHT FOR TODAY

No man is free who is not master of himself.

-- Epictetus

EDITORIAL

Eliminate Leprosy

World Leprosy Day is observed on the last Sunday of January each year. The theme of this year's World Leprosy Day is 'Beat Leprosy'. The primary purpose of this day is to raise awareness about leprosy, eliminate the stigma associated with the disease, promote efforts to reduce the infection, improve the quality of life for those affected, and promote the dignity of people infected by leprosy. Nepal government has set a goal to eradicate leprosy and make Nepal a completely leprosy-free country by 2030. But still, thousands of cases of leprosy are being reported each year. So it seems that we need to work harder to achieve this goal.

Leprosy is an infectious disease caused by the bacterium Mycobacterium leprae. It primarily affects the skin and peripheral nerves but can also involve other organs. Leprosy has been known since ancient times, and it carries a social stigma and superstitions due to historical misconceptions and fear associated with the disease. Although there is no vaccine for the disease, it is treated with multi-drug therapy, an approach that combines different types of antibiotics.

According to data from the Epidemiology and Disease Control Division of the Department of Health Services (EDCD), in the fiscal year 2022/23 alone 2,522 new leprosy cases were reported in Nepal. Dr. Prashanna Napit, Section Chief at the Leprosy Control and Disability Management Section of EDCD, has revealed that currently, 2,510 leprosy patients are receiving treatment. Among them, 1,049 are women, and 181 are children under 14 years of age. The new patients include 189 in disabled condition, eight of them children.

Dr. Napit emphasised an accumulation of leprosy incidents in the Madhes districts and Lumbini Province, revealing that one out of every 10,000 individuals is affected by leprosy. Furthermore, he observed the existence of leprosy patients in 14 districts. Leprosy is a disease of global health concern, with a higher prevalence in some developing countries. Efforts by international organisations, governments, and non-governmental organisations aim to eliminate leprosy as a public health problem. It is important to note that leprosy is a treatable disease, and early detection and proper treatment can prevent disabilities and reduce the risks of transmission.

The World Health Organisation (WHO) has been working towards the goal of eliminating leprosy as a public health problem, but challenges remain in certain regions. Additionally, efforts to reduce the stigma associated with leprosy can encourage individuals to seek medical attention sooner, facilitating prompt diagnosis and treatment. We should take World Leprosy Day as a day to beat the stigma attached to it and an opportunity to show compassion and respect to all the leprosy survivors, who bravely fought this infectious disease.

Despite advancements, individuals who have successfully recovered from leprosy still face ongoing social stigmatisation. They contend that Nepali legislation, specifically Section 71 of the Civil Code 2074, sustains discrimination against leprosy survivors. This provision forbids marriage with a person with leprosy and permits the annulment of such marriages. This provision needs to be revised as leprosy is curable and no longer a threat as it used to be in the past, and we should strive to create a world where every individual gets a chance to live with dignity and happiness.

Migration Spurs Development

SABINE BALK

According to the World Bank, around 2.3 per cent of the world's population live outside their home country. That is 184 million people, including 37 million refugees. There are many reasons why people decide to move across borders. The World Bank finds that most are driven by economic aspirations or the hope of escaping conflicts or other forms of violence. One factor that intensifies all drivers of mobility is climate change.

The World Development Report notes that the migration landscape is changing significantly. Migration is coming to be seen as a necessity by all countries, regardless of income level, because populations are ageing rapidly and competition for labour and talent is becoming global.

The World Bank authors call for all migration flows to be managed in a way that maximises development benefits. They warn that "current approaches often fail both migrants and nationals. They create large inefficiencies and missed opportunities in both destination and origin countries". This, the experts say, currently results in a great deal of human suffering; anti-migrant movements have emerged in many countries.

Migration should be viewed objectively. It entails both benefits and costs – for the migrants, their countries of origin and their destinations. According to the World Bank, destination countries are in the best position to make migration a success. The policies that they implement define and regulate who crosses their borders, who is legally allowed to stay and what rights they have. "If managed well, migration can continue to increase prosperity and help to achieve the United Nations' Sustainable Development Goals", the authors write.

One of the central messages of the World Bank report is that origin and destination countries need to ensure better strategic management of all types of migration. The authors make a distinction between migrants and refugees who offer skills that are needed in destination labour markets and those who do not. Regardless of whether they are high- or low-skilled, economic migrants and refugees can both be a strong match for the needs of a destination country. Their movement results in considerable development benefits for the migrants themselves, the destination country and the country of origin. The costs are generally smaller than the benefits.

The World Development Report states that the primary policy goal should be to further increase the benefits of migration and reduce the costs. This can be achieved, it says, by a combination of policy actions in origin countries – facilitation of remittances, for example, and mitigation of brain drain effects. In host countries, migrants and refugees should receive targeted support and be granted rights and access to labour markets. Measures should also be taken to facilitate their social integration. Refugees who cannot be integrated into the labour market of the destination country must be accepted, regardless of the cost, in accordance with international law.

The report emphasises that point, adding that the international community needs to reduce and share the resulting costs for destination countries. Migrants who do not have refugee status and have no chance of employment in a destination country pose considerable challenges for that country. However, as the authors explain, the overall number of such migrants is comparatively small. Their involuntary repatriation needs to be carried out in a humane manner. The aim must be to create incentives and employment in home countries so that such people do not feel the need to emigrate. International cooperation has a role to play here in supporting development in countries of origin.

-- Development and Cooperation

NA Election Outcome

No Threat To Ruling Coalition



Narayan Upadhyay

Discord among the ruling alliance's main parties emerged following the National Assembly (NA) election's shocking Koshi results. The alliance's top brass had hoped to fill one of the female quota seats with a CPN-Maoist Centre candidate, but a number of Nepali Congress lawmakers, municipal chiefs and deputy chiefs, and rural municipality chairs and deputy chairs cast a cross-vote in favour of the UML candidate, who won the NA ballot held on January 25. Soon after the unexpected outcome, Maoist Centre officials began berating the Nepali Congress for their candidate Champa Karki's loss in the election. After seeing that their combined vote total would be higher than that of opposing parties like the UML and Rastriya Prajatantra Party, the Nepali Congress and Maoist Centre decided to field a single candidate each for Koshi province and ensure their election.

The UML candidate, however, narrowly defeated her opponent for the NA female seat, thanks to the votes of a small number of Nepali Congress voters who were visibly dissatisfied with the party leadership in the centre. But out of the 19 NA seats up for grabs, the alliance has taken home eighteen. The Nepali Congress bagged 10, the Maoist Centre 5, the Unified Socialist 2, and Janata Samajwadi Party 1. The outcome has made the Maoist Centre the number one party in the NA, while the UML, the first party, has now been relegated to the third position.

Cross-voting

Some disgruntled Congress members in Koshi allegedly gave back to the UML by supporting UML candidate Rukmini Koirala, according to observers. The UML was instrumental in Kedar Karki's (a member of the Nepali Congress) election as chief minister last October. The continuing power struggle inside the Nepali Congress is partly to blame for this as well. The group led by Shekhar Koirala was successful in receiving the support of the UML in Koshi to elect Karki as Chief Minister.

The rebel faction's leader, Koirala, is routinely seen hobnobbing with the UML chief and was key in receiving the main opposition's backing. In Koshi, many had anticipated that the two alliance candidates — Congress stalwart Krishna Prasad Sitaula and Maoist Champa Karki —might lose owing to the control of the Koirala-led faction members as well as the smaller vote weight of the alliance against the opposition. However, much to the delight of Sitaula, who had lost his House of Representatives election from Jhapa, the disgruntled Congress members voted for him to ensure his election but went against the Maoist-fielded female candidate. With the victory, Sitaula is projected to become the next NA chairperson.

Earlier, some had thought that both coalition candidates would win since the alliance was ahead with thin votes. Also, just before the NA polling, the UML and RPP chiefs came together and deployed their resources in Koshi to ensure the UML and RPP candidates won. The RPP candidate, Uddhav Poudel, who was matched against Sitaula too, lost by a small margin. The unexpected outcome, an obvious result of the Congress members' cross-voting, did ruffle the feathers of certain Maoist officials who wanted the party leadership to reconsider their alliance with the Nepali Congress, who, according to them, is 'ready to backstab them' anytime they have the chance.

> There is less probability that the alliance would split apart because of the loss of a candidate for the NA slot, although it has upset a major partner.

Surprisingly, Maoist Centre chair Prachanda has not voiced a harsh word against the alliance partner over the result, as he recognised that the defeat of his candidate was the work of a section that is not satisfied with president Sher Bahadur Deuba. Some Congressmen close to Deuba indicated that they were also not happy with the loss of the Maoist member and then roundly laid the blame on the faction members led by Koirala for the unexpected loss. Many Congressmen attacked their members, who cross-voted, for not respecting the sanctity of the alliance by supporting the biggest opposition party, which is always ready to topple the coalition government at the centre and provinces.

Now, many are asking: will the coalition between the Congress and Maoist Centre disintegrate following the NA election outcome in Koshi province? Given the existing structure of the coalition and the composition of the administration, it is less probable that the Maoist Centre will rupture its alliance with Congress. Indeed, the partnership with the Congress has placed the former rebels in the driving seat of the government and has also enabled numerous ex-rebellious figures to become significant ministries. If and when they leave the coalition, they will presumably join forces with the UML, with whom they have no positive relations. A year ago, they broke ties with the UML to join up with Congress.

Dissatisfaction

It seems that the Maoist Centre Chair, Prachanda, has found a close friend in Deuba, who has until now been playing second fiddle despite the Congress being the largest party in the coalition government. Deuba is generally reluctant to criticise the government or Maoist leaders, especially when the latter commit mistakes that have an impact on the well-being of the alliance. Besides the Koirala-led group, there are others in Congress who regularly voice their unhappiness with their leadership, making coalitions and granting free hand to the Maoist Chair in the cabinet. The level of patience displayed by the Congress leadership is largely due to the forthcoming opportunity that would make him the next PM, probably in a year's time. The five-party coalition has been created with an agreement dictating that the Congress president will become Prime Minister on a rotating basis.

The benefit of continuing in power for the full term of five years despite being in third place in the House of Representatives will be the key to keeping intact the existing alliance between the Congress, the Maoist Centre, and three fringe parties. Hence, there is less probability that the alliance would split apart because of the loss of a candidate for the NA slot, although it has upset a major partner.

(The author of former managing editor of this daily.)

Expedite Distribution Of National ID Cards



Uttam Maharjan

Nepal has adopted the system of national identity cards (NIDs) as a replacement for citizenship certificates. The citizenship certificates are manual documents with photos, whereas the NIDs are digital documents with biometrics, digital photos and digital personal details. NIDs are based on biometric and demographic data of citizens and have unique numbers for each citizen. After the full implementation of the NID system in the country, the NIDs will be used as an integrated document that serves as a citizenship certificate, a voter card, a social security card and so on. Driving licences, vehicle ownership books, banking services and tax payment systems will also be integrated into the NIDs.

Further, public service facilities will be made available to the citizens on the basis of the NIDs. However, the NIDs will not serve as passports and driving licences.

The personal details of all Nepali citizens will be stored in the National Data Repertory. The Department of National ID and Civil Registration (DoNIDCR) is responsible for the management of NIDs. The DoNIDCR was created five years ago by merging the National ID Management Centre and the Department of Civil Registration. The DoNIDCR is also entrusted with registering personal events of the citizens. In Nepal, personal events include birth, death, marriage, divorce and migration.

Commitment

As per the commitment made to the UN Economic and Social Commission for Asia and the Pacific (UNESCAP), Nepal will have to record births of all Nepalis and increase the registration of other personal events by 2024 AD. The DoNIDCR is working to meet these targets. The DoNIDCR is also assigned the task of managing and distributing social security allowances to the eligible citizens. Social security allowances are distributed to seven target groups: senior citizens, Dalits, the disabled, tribes on the verge of extinction, widows, single women and children of Dalit and backward families. Besides, nutrition allowances are also provided for specific target groups so as to mitigate their poverty to some extent.

During the fiscal year 2075/76 B.S., the DoNIDCR initiated the distribution of NIDs as a pilot project by distributing NIDs among the residents of Panchthar district and government employees working at Singh Durbar. The DoNIDCR has planned to distribute NIDs in three stages. The importance of NIDs is growing all over the world. Many countries have a system of digital IDs. Digital IDs have features that can be linked to public services and are used for various purposes in an integrated manner. The use of such digital IDs would contribute to national inclusivity – connecting citizens to various public services and national activities such as elections.

The government announced through its budget statement and policy and programmes of the fiscal year 2066/67 B.S. that the NID system would be introduced in the country. According to the government's policy and programmes of the fiscal year 2076/77, the distribution of NIDs will be completed in four years. The National Identity Card Act, 2076 and the National Identity Card Rules, 2077 are in force to manage the NIDs. In 2018 AD, the government inked a contract with IDEMIA for the processing and distribution of NIDs. IDEMIA is a France-based multilateral company, which deals, inter alia, in biometric identification products and software such as facial, fingerprint, finger vein and iris recognition systems.

> That NIDs are a must for preventing duplication of voter registration and identity theft and for maintaining proper records of the migration of voters.

The distribution of NIDs is, however, proceeding at a snail's pace. That one cannot obtain one's NID even within a year through a normal process is a matter of shame. The same is the case with the issuance of smart driving licences. Those who have passed the driving test and who have got their licences renewed are compelled to drive their vehicles on revenue payment receipts. The receipts mention the names of licence-holders, licence numbers, expiry dates, categories of vehicles and the like.

As per the DoNIDCR, applications from over 11.4 million people have been obtained but very few NIDs have been distributed so far. Even if the DoNIDCR has failed to expedite the process of distribution, the Department of Passports made the NIDs mandatory to obtain e-passports on 01.08.2078. The NIDs have also been made mandatory to sit for medical entrance exams. The NIDs are not required in other sectors, where citizenship certificates are required.

Inordinate delay

As such, the people are suffering for no fault of theirs. Those who need passports to go abroad for jobs or other purposes are hart hit. They have to obtain NIDs at any cost. Viewed thus, the government's inefficiency has clearly come out into the open. Still, there is no one who can challenge the government. Rather, the DoNIDCR says that NIDs are a must for preventing duplication of voter registration and identity theft and for maintaining proper records of the migration of voters. Yes, there is no doubt about what the DoNIDCR says but there has been an inordinate delay in the issuance and distribution of the NIDs.

It goes without saying that the NID system has been launched with good intentions. But the issuance and distribution of the NIDs are shambolic. Moreover, cybersecurity experts have expressed concerns that the safety of the sensitive personal data of Nepalis is at stake and that such details may be misused to the detriment of the country. Anyway, the government should take concrete measures to distribute the NIDs to the eligible citizens within the shortest possible time. At a time when the people are frustrated at the delay in obtaining driving licences, the snail-paced distribution of the NIDs has further heightened their frustration. This shows that the government is indifferent to such sensitive public services as driving licences and NIDs. It is high time the government changed its working style and increased its efficiency.

(Maharjan has been regularly writing on contemporary issues for this daily since 2000.)

50 YEARS AGO

THE RISING NEPAL

January 30, 1974

Birgunj Sugar Factory Sets Production Target

Kathmandu, Jan. 30: Birgunj Sugar Factory has a target of producing about 80,000 quintal of sugar this year by crushing 950,000 quintal of sugarcane, reports RSS.

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READER'S MAIL

Control Gun Menace

As for America, it is back to square one when it comes to the flourishing gun culture.

Given the frequent shooting incidents in America, the government cannot do anything to immediately stop the gun culture.

But there are ways to do so. There have been various reasons quoted for such sad incidents that are almost quite common in the USA.

Quite interestingly, social factors like jobs, immigration policy are now being dragged to these sad stories. The American government should be very careful of its action against the backdrops of gun menace.

More than anything else, it is also about cultivating the minds and hearts of the American youth.

To start with, the American educational system should be molded to instill a sense of responsibility into American students at their budding stages.



Consequently, these stringent and careful steps will lead America to a new path sooner or later.

Besides, the culture needs to be protected at all costs for social harmony.

With more attention to such social activities, America will be shifting from the current difficult situation to a calm and beautiful environment sometime hence.

P. Senthil Durai
Mumbai, India

TAILPIECE

A crumbling old church building needed remodelling, so, during his sermon, the preacher made an impassioned appeal looking directly at the richest man in town. At the end of the sermon, the rich man stood up and announced, "Pastor, I will contribute $1,000."

Just then, plaster fell from the ceiling and struck the rich man on the shoulder. He promptly stood back up and shouted, "Pastor, I will increase my donation to $5,000."

Before he could sit back down, plaster fell on him again, and again he virtually screamed, "Pastor, I will double my last pledge. "He sat down, and a larger chunk of plaster fell on his head. He stood up once more and hollered, "Pastor, I will give $20,000!"

This prompted a deacon to shout, "Hit him again, Lord! Hit him again!"

Pakistan and Iran agree to work together to improve security

AP
Islamabad, Jan. 29

Pakistan and Iran on Monday agreed to work together to improve security cooperation in the wake of deadly airstrikes by Tehran and Islamabad earlier this month that killed at least 11 people, marking a significant escalation in fraught relations between the neighbors.

The development came after the top Iranian diplomat, Hossein Amirabdollahian, held talks in Islamabad with his Pakistani counterpart, Jalil Abbas Jilani. The Iranian foreign minister also met with Pakistan's caretaker Prime Minister Anwaarul-Haq-Kakar.

Iran-Pakistan ties were dramatically imperiled on Jan. 17, when Iran launched airstrikes in Pakistan's restive southwestern Baluchistan province, targeting what Tehran said were hideouts of the anti-Iran Sunni militant group Jaish al-Adl, or the Army of Justice. Pakistan said two children were killed and tree others were wounded.

Angered over the strikes, Pakistan recalled its ambassadors from Tehran and launched airstrikes against alleged militant hideouts inside Iran, in the Sistan and Baluchestan province, killing at least nine people. Islamabad said it was targeting Baluch militant groups with separatist goals.

At a joint news conference later Monday, Amirabdollahian and Jilani said they would work through existing channels in their leadership, diplomatic and military levels to cooperate with each other.



PHOTO: AP

Iran's Foreign Minister Hossein Amirabdollahian, front right, walks with his Pakistani counterpart Jalil Abbas Jilani, front left, upon his arrival for a meeting at the Ministry of Foreign Affairs in Islamabad, Pakistan, Monday, Jan. 29, 2024.

Jilani said the two countries were able to bring the "situation back to normal in the shortest possible time" after the airstrikes because both sides had agreed to resume dialogue to resolve all issues.

"Terrorism poses a common challenge to our countries," Jilani said and stressed that "respect for sovereignty and territorial integrity remains the immutable and foundational principle of this cooperation" between the neighbors.

He announced regular future meetings at top ministerial levels and also between liaison officers.

Iran and Pakistan "strongly respect sovereignty and territorial integrity of each other," Amirabdollahian. "We will tell all terrorists that we will not ... provide them with any opportunity to endanger our common security."

Amirabdollahian said Pakistan and Iran will also set up free trade economic zones near the border regions to enhance their bilateral trade.

Iran and nuclear-armed Pakistan have long regarded each other with suspicion over militant attacks on their sides of the border. Experts say the tit-for-tat strikes this month were at least partially prompted by internal political pressures though they also raised the threat of violence spreading across the Middle East, already unsettled by Israel's war with Hamas in Gaza.

During his visit, Amirabdollahian was also expecting to brief his hosts about an incident Saturday in which unknown gunmen shot and killed at least four Pakistani laborers and wounded three others in Iran's Sistan and Baluchestan province. Pakistan has condemned the killings, describing the attack as "horrifying and despicable".

Relatives of the slain Pakistanis rallied on Sunday, demanding that the bodies of their loved ones be brought home. Pakistan said arrangements were being made for that with Iran's help and that the three wounded workers were being treated at an Iranian hospital.

JAPAN'S MOON LANDER RESUMES OPERATIONS

AFP
Japan, Jan. 29

Japan's Moon lander has resumed operations, the space agency said, indicating that power had been restored.

"Last evening we succeeded in establishing communication with SLIM, and resumed operations," JAXA said on X, formerly Twitter.

"We immediately started scientific observations with MBC, and have successfully obtained first light for 10-band observation," it said, referring to the lander's multiband spectroscopic camera.

The agency also posted on X an image shot by the probe of "toy poodle", a rock observed near the lander.

The touchdown earlier this month made Japan only the fifth nation to achieve a soft lunar landing, after the United States, the Soviet Union, China and India.

But after the Smart Lander for Investigating Moon (SLIM) touched down, JAXA had said that it could not confirm that the lightweight craft's solar batteries were generating power.

PRISM

British Columbia's rejected vanity plates

Officials in British Columbia revealed their list of personalized license plate applications that were rejected for reasons including abusive or sexually suggestive language.

The Insurance Corporation of British Columbia, which is responsible for issuing license plates, said about 9,500 vanity plate applications were received in 2023, and about 2,600 of those were rejected for various reasons.

The plates rejected for being "abusive, obscene or derogatory" include "TURD," "SOMPIG," "STR8-WM" and multiple variations of "IDGAF."

Plates barred for being "sexually suggestive" or having "inappropriate connotations" include "BOINK," "HOGASM," "HUSTLR," "LZY BUT" and multiple plates ending with the numbers "69."

Thief steals 7 king cakes

New Orleans : With their purple, gold and green colors and toy babies hidden inside, king cakes are staples of Mardi Gras celebrations in New Orleans, but apparently they're also valuable enough to steal — at least this time of year during the Carnival season.

A thief stole seven king cakes — about as many as he could carry — during a break-in last week at a New Orleans bakery. The thief also took cash and a case of vodka from Bittersweet Confections last Wednesday, according to New Orleans Police Department.

"Our king cakes are just that good," the bakery wrote on social media. "But please come and purchase one during our regular store hours."

While it's a secular celebration, Carnival in New Orleans — and around the world — is strongly linked to Christian and Roman Catholic traditions. The season begins on Jan. 6, the 12th day after Christmas, and continues until Mardi Gras, known as Fat Tuesday, which is the final day of feasting, drinking and revelry before Ash Wednesday and the fasting associated with Lent.

(Agencies)

North Korea says leader Kim supervised tests of cruise missiles



PHOTO: AP

This photo provided by the North Korean government, shows what it says a test firing of Pulhwasal-3-31 in North Korea Sunday, Jan. 28, 2024.

AP
South Korea, Jan. 29

North Korean leader Kim Jong Un supervised test-firings of new cruise missiles designed to be launched from submarines and also reviewed efforts to build a nuclear-powered submarine while reiterating his goal of building a nuclear-armed navy to counter what he portrays as growing external threats, state media said Monday.

The report came a day after South Korea's military said it detected North Korea firing multiple cruise missiles over waters near the eastern port of Sinpo, where the North has a major shipyard developing submarines. It was the latest in a streak of weapons demonstrations by North Korea amid increasing tensions with the United States, South Korea and Japan.

North Korea's official newspaper Rodong Sinmun published photos of what appeared to be at least two missiles fired separately. Both created grayish-white clouds as they broke the water surface and soared into the air at an angle of around 45 degrees, which possibly suggests they were fired from torpedo launch tubes.

State media said the missiles were Pulhwasal-3-31, a new type of weapon first tested last week in land-based launches from North Korea's western coast.

The reports implied that two missiles were fired during the test. KCNA said the missiles flew more than two hours before accurately striking an island target, but it did not specify the vessel used for the launches. North Korea in past years has fired missiles both from developmental, missile-firing submarines and underwater test platforms built on barges.

Lee Sung Joon, spokesperson of South Korea's Joint Chiefs of Staff, said the South Korean and U.S. militaries were analysing the launches, including the possibility that the North exaggerated the flight times.

In recent years, North Korea has tested a variety of missiles designed to be fired from submarines as it pursues the ability to conduct nuclear strikes from underwater. In theory, such capacity would bolster its deterrent by ensuring a survivable capability to retaliate after absorbing a nuclear attack on land.

Missile-firing submarines would also add a maritime threat to the North's growing collection of solid-fuel weapons fired from land vehicles that are designed to overwhelm missile defences of South Korea, Japan and the United States.

Still, it would take considerable time, resources and technological improvements for the heavily sanctioned nation to build a fleet of at least several submarines that could travel quietly and execute attacks reliably, analysts say.

The North's official Korean Central News Agency said Kim expressed satisfaction after the missiles accurately hit their sea targets during Sunday's test.

He then issued unspecified important tasks for "realizing the nuclear weaponization of the navy and expanding the sphere of operation," which he described as crucial goals considering the "prevailing situation and future threats," the report said. KCNA said Kim was also briefed on efforts to develop a nuclear-propelled submarine and other advanced naval vessels.

North Korea has an estimated 70 to 90 diesel-powered submarines in one of the world's largest submarine fleets. But they are mostly aging vessels capable of launching only torpedoes and mines.

Yemen's Houthi rebels say they attacked US warship



AP
jerusalem, Jan. 29

Yemen's Houthi rebels said they attacked a U.S. Navy mobile base at sea Monday without offering evidence, something immediately rejected by an American defence official.

The claimed attack targeted the USS Lewis B. Puller, a ship that serves as a floating landing base. The Puller had been earlier stationed in the Arabian Sea as part of American efforts to curtail Houthi attacks on commercial shipping through the Red Sea and Gulf of Aden.

Houthi military spokesperson Brig. Gen. Yahya Saree said in a statement it fired a missile at the Puller in the Gulf of Aden. He offered no evidence.

Houthi attacks will continue "until the aggression is stopped, and the siege is lifted on the people of Palestine in the Gaza Strip," Saree said in the statement.

A U.S. defence official, speaking on condition of anonymity to discuss intelligence matters, said there had been no reported attack on the Puller. However, the Houthis have previously launched missiles that did not reach their intended target, instead crashing down onto the land or sea.

The Puller served as a mobile base for the U.S. Navy SEALs who conducted a Jan. 11 operation seizing Iranian-made ballistic missile and cruise missile components believed to be bound for Yemen. Two SEALs went missing in the operation and are presumed to have died.

Since November, the rebels have repeatedly targeted ships in the Red Sea over Israel's offensive in Gaza against Hamas. But they have frequently targeted vessels with tenuous or no clear links to Israel, imperilling shipping in a key route for global trade between Asia, the Mideast and Europe.

The Houthis hit a commercial vessel with a missile on Friday, sparking a fire that burned for hours.

NASA's little helicopter on Mars has logged its last flight

AP
Cape Canaveral, Fla., Jan. 29

NASA's little Mars helicopter has flown its last flight.

The space agency announced Thursday that the 4-pound (1.8-kilogram) chopper named Ingenuity can no longer fly because of rotor blade damage. While it remains upright and in contact with flight controllers, its $85 million mission is officially over, officials said.

Originally intended as a short-term tech demo, Ingenuity logged 72 flights over three years at Mars. It accumulated more than two hours of flight time, traveling 11 miles (18 kilometres). That's more than 14 times farther than planned, according to NASA. It soared as high as 79 feet (24 meters) and hit speeds of up to 22.4 mph (36 kph).



PHOTO: AP

In this image made available by NASA, the Mars Ingenuity helicopter hovers above the surface of the planet during its second flight on April 22, 2021.

"While we knew this day was inevitable, it doesn't make it any easier" to announce the end of the mission, said NASA's Lori Glaze. "It's almost an understatement to say that it has surpassed expectations."

Ingenuity hitched a ride on NASA's Perseverance rover, landing on Mars in 2021. It ended up serving as a scout for the rover and proved powered flight was possible in the thin Martian atmosphere.

Images beamed back this week from its last flight showed that one or more of its rotor blades suffered damage while landing and may have hit the surface. The blades are no longer usable, according to NASA.

The helicopter ascended to 40 feet (12 meters) on its final flight last week, hovering for a few seconds before descending. It mysteriously lost contact with the nearby rover — its communication relay — while still 3 feet (1 meter) off the ground. Once communication was restored, the damage was confirmed. The reason for the loss of communication is under investigation.

Ingenuity's success prompted NASA in 2022 to add two mini helicopters to a future Mars mission.

TODAY IN HISTORY

1862 – The first American ironclad warship, the USS Monitor is launched.
1806 – The original Lower Trenton Bridge (also called the Trenton Makes the World Takes Bridge), which spans the Delaware River between Morrisville, Pennsylvania and Trenton, New Jersey, is opened.
1820 – Edward Brans field sights the Trinity Peninsula and claims the discovery of Antarctica.
1902 – The first Anglo-Japanese Alliance is signed in London.
1956 – In the United States, Civil Rights Movement leader Martin Luther King Jr.'s home is bombed in retaliation for the Montgomery bus boycott.
1972 – Pakistan leaves the Commonwealth of Nations in protest of its recognition of breakaway Bangladesh.

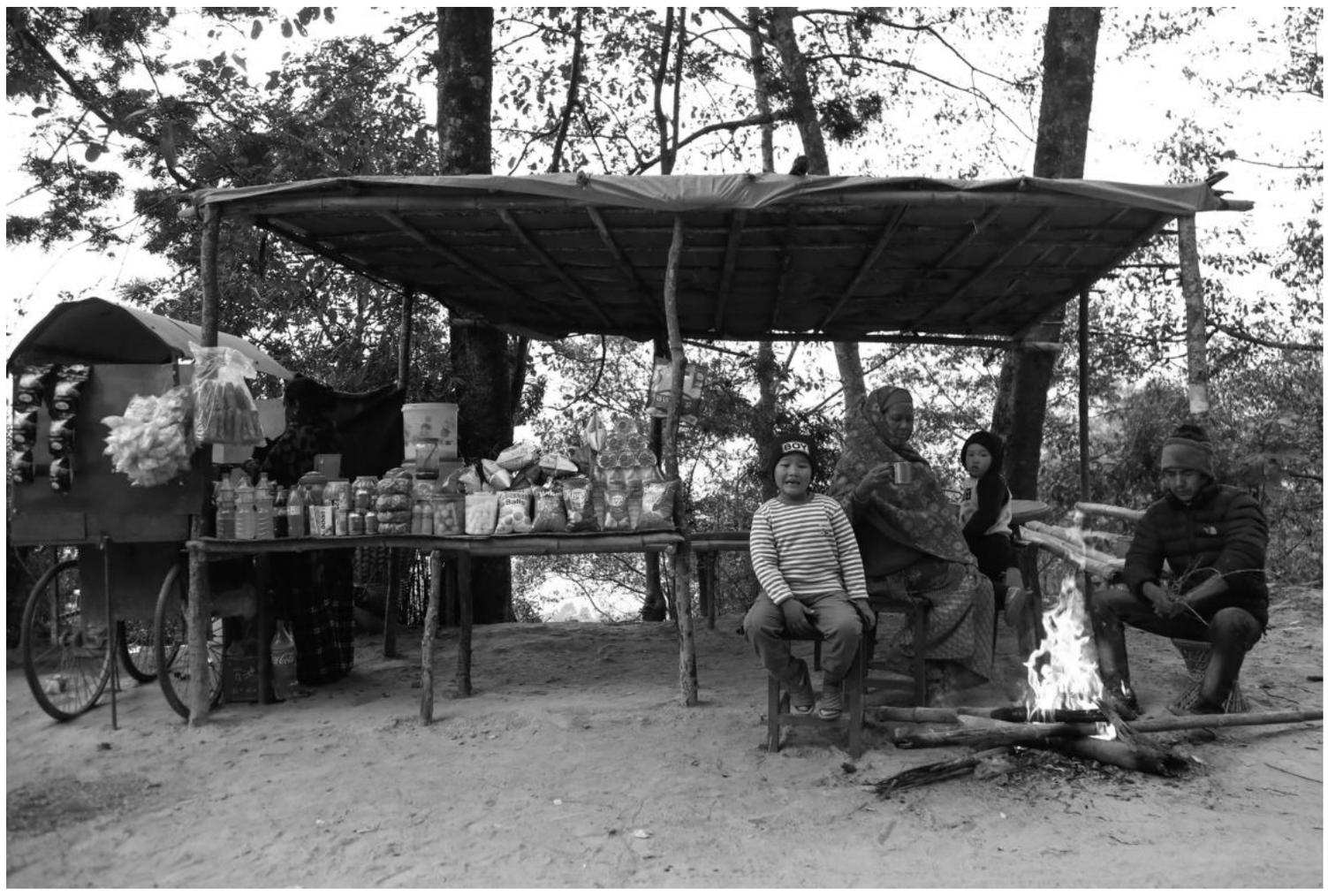


PHOTO: SUJAN GURUNG/TRN

Locals warming themselves by fire near Mudkhu View Tower as temperature drops.

Utilise Karnali's medicinal herb resources: PM

BY A STAFF REPORTER
Kathmandu, Jan. 29

Prime Minister Pushpa Kamal Dahal 'Prachanda' has emphasized the need for Karnali Province to play a crucial role in the production of medicines, leveraging its abundant natural resources and assets.

During his address at the ninth assembly of the Karnali Academy of Health Sciences, he underscored the significance of the province's extensive natural and herbal resources, urging for the initiation of efforts not only in medicine production but also in the diverse utilisation of these natural assets.

Prime Minister Prachanda further directed the institution to undertake the necessary preparations for drug manufacturing.

Despite acknowledging the challenges posed by limited resources, Prime Minister Prachanda commended the positive efforts made by the foundation.

He pledged government support to harness the vast potential of Karnali in the future, taking note of existing issues such as inadequate road infrastructure, a shortage of skilled medical professionals, and other resource constraints that pose challenges to service delivery and workforce development. The Prime Minister assured that forthcoming government initiatives will be tailored to address these concerns.

Expressing awareness of the aspirations and needs of doctors, technicians, and employees regarding professional development and service facilities, Prime Minister Prachanda gave his assurance that their demands would be gradually addressed.

In addition, during the assembly, he advocated for Nepal to become a 'hub' of higher education, citing its significant potential. The Prime Minister expressed confidence in the institution's future progress, noting its direct service provision to Karnali Province and the most underserved areas of the Sudurpaschim Province, along with the production of skilled health workers.

Highlighting the foundation's crucial role during challenging times, such as the COVID-19 pandemic and recent earthquakes, Prime Minister Prachanda commended its efforts in preparedness, vigilance, rescue, and treatment with a strong sense of responsibility.

Government media should be accountable towards people: Minister Sharma

RSS
Kathmandu, Jan. 29

Minister for Communications and Information Technology, Rekha Sharma, has said the government has brought Public Service Broadcasting Bill to make the government owned media professional and accountable towards people.

At a discussion on the theme 'Public Service Broadcasting Bill' in the Education, Health and Information Technology Committee under the House of Representatives held on Monday, Minister Sharma shared that the proposed bill was introduced with the concept that public media should work as the bridge between the people and government in an independent manner. "We have been frequently saying that the government-owned media should be accountable and responsible to the people", she mentioned.

Minister Sharma expected suggestions from the Committee in course of amendment to the bill. "The bill has been introduced with an objective of merging Radio Nepal and Nepal Television and making government-owned media responsible towards the people after further advancing their capacity", she stressed.

The Communications Minister explained that the government has made preparation to present the bill in coming Parliament session scheduled to take place on February 5. Lawmakers who registered amendment proposals to the bill expressed the view that the public media should be made independent, professional and accountable.

Lawmakers, including Pradeep Poudel, Mahesh Kumar Bartaula, Raghuji Panta, Chandra Bhandari, Madhav Sapkota, Devendra Poudel, Sunita Baral, Suana Shrestha, Toshima Karki, Prem Suwal, Narayani Sharma and Dipa Sharma among others laid emphasis on the need of making the media accountable to the people.

Similarly, Committee Chairperson Bhanu Bhakta Joshi stressed the need of endorsing the bill received in the Committee soon. The bill would be forwarded for clause-wise discussion from Tuesday's meeting, he said.

Cold related ailments starts taking toll in Tarai belt

Relief distributed in affected settlements in Bara

BY SHIV SHANKAR MISHRA
Bara, Jan. 29

Ongoing cold waves have claimed two lives in Bara. A 65-year-old woman residing in a public shelter in Simhanashi Tole of Baragadhi Rural Municipality, and Biren Sahni, 45, a fishmonger died due to hypothermia.

Biran Sahni, 45, a fishmonger who went fishing in the pond of Kalaiya Sub-Metropolitan City-16 Dohri Tole, died due to hypothermia. He was undergoing treatment at the Kalaiya Provincial Hospital, but could not be saved as it was too late, said Dadhiram Neupane, Deputy Superintendent of Police and the spokesperson for the Bara District Police Office.

"Thirty nine people died from cold-related ailments from August to mid-January of the current fiscal year. Last year, 54 people succumbed to cold-related ailments in Bara," said Neupane.

Children, pregnant women, chronically ill individuals, and the elderly have been hard hit by the ongoing cold waves. Dr. Ranjit Prasad Yadav, a physician at Narayani Hospital, said that children and the elderly are experiencing respiratory problems.

Out of about 250 patients who come daily, 15 to 20 are patients with asthma patients, 10 to 15 are stroke patients, and 25 to 30 are patients with pneumonia in the hospital.

Dr. Santosh Yadav said that apart from advising them to stay safe from the cold, they were instructed people leave home only for essential work.

Assistant Chief District Officer of Bara, Krishna Prasad Acharya, said that the District Emergency Operation Centre is taking initiatives for the necessary management of the affected people.

He informed that to avoid the repetition of the meeting held by the Disaster Management Committee in January, the municipality and the committee are coordinating and informing each other. They are also distributing clothes and warm blankets to the very poor, and marginalised individuals to help them survive the cold.

"I have heard that the local bodies are also distributing blankets in certain areas, but I have no specific information about that. This year, 2,000 blankets have been allocated by the Madhes Province government for the people affected by the cold. We have been coordinating with the local government to identify impoverished settlements and distribute blankets to those in need," Acharya said.

So far, 100 blankets have been distributed in Kolhavi Municipality, 100 blankets in Adarshkotwal Rural Municipality, 150 blankets in Karaiyamai Rural Municipality, and 160 blankets in Subarna Rural Municipality.

Acharya informed that the central government had allocated an amount ranging from Rs. 800,000 to Rs. 1 million last fiscal year for the people affected by cold waves. However, this year, they have not allocated any budget for the citizens affected by the cold.

DIRECT FLIGHT TO MANASAROVAR RESUMES

RSS
Nepalgunj, Jan. 29

A direct flight from Nepalgunj to Kailash Manasarovar in Tibetan Autonomous Region of China has started today after a lot of effort. A chartered airplane of Shree Airlines boarding 38 Indian tourists its maiden flight to Kailash Manasarovar today, informed Keshav Neupane, regional director of the Siddhartha Business Group. The Indian tourists from various cities such as New Delhi, Mumbai, Gujarat and the Uttar Pradesh State were flow to Kailash Manasarovar, according to Neupane.

Minister Saud discusses summit with Nobel laureate Satyarthi

BY A STAFF REPORTER
Kathmandu, Jan. 29



Foreign Minister NP Saud and Nobel Peace Prize winner Kailash Satyarthi held a meeting at the Ministry of Foreign Affairs (MoFA) on Monday.

FM Saud mentioned the contribution made by Satyarthi in Nepal and India in the field of child rights and social service and charity work. Satyarthi was awarded the Nobel Peace Prize in 2014 for his work in the field of child rights.

Satyarthi reached the MoFA along with Chief Minister of Lumbini Province, Dilli Bahadur Chaudhary, to discuss the preparation of the 'Laureates and Leaders' summit to be held in Lumbini on March 11-12 this year. The Lumbini Government is organising the summit for the welfare of children, sustainable development and peace at Lumbini, the birthplace of Gautama Buddha. It has included the summit in its annual policy and programmes and budget of the current Fiscal Year 2023/24.

According the Lumbini government, experts working in the field of development from all over the world, senior officials of United Nations agencies, government and non-government sector representatives will be invited to the summit.

UML demands withdrawal of ordinance in Koshi

BY OUR CORRESPONDENT
Biratnagar, Jan. 29

> If not done so, we will call for a special session and annul the ordinance from there itself. We warn not to undermine the strong opposition in the parliament.

The parliamentary party of the CPN-UML in the Koshi Provincial Assembly has urged the ruling parties to immediately withdraw the ordinance recently issued by the provincial government.

Rewati Raman Bhandari, Chief Whip of the CPN-UML parliamentary party, warned of a strong protest against the government if the ordinance was not withdrawn.

The Koshi Province government issued an ordinance amending several provincial laws on January 20. Meanwhile, the CPN-UML objected to the ordinance stating that the government had amended the laws with ulterior intentions and the Chief Minister was trying to proceed arbitrarily.

Chief Whip Bhandari said, "The party demands withdrawl the ordinance before the upcoming session. If not done so, we will call for a special session and annul the ordinance from there itself. We warn not to undermine the strong opposition in the parliament." He added that the CPN-UML would not allow the next session of the parliament to proceed.

The Koshi Province government issued an ordinance amending seven laws, including the law related to the remuneration and facilities of the members and officials of the Provincial Assembly, the provincial health law, the provincial forest law, the provincial building law and others.

In the amendment, the CPN-UML has raised numerous objections, particularly in the provisions related to increasing the remuneration and facilities of the members and officials of the provincial assembly, dismissing hospital development committees and extending the term of the executive chief of the Provincial Investment Board.

54,720...

In the province, from policemen to DSP posts will be directly adjusted.

There will be one Deputy Inspector General (DIG) and three SSP posts in each province. The DIG will be provincial police chief. There are two posts of SSP in the provincial police office and one in the provincial training centre. Accordingly, the posts of seven DIGs, 21 SSPs, 69 SPs, 181 DSPs, and 732 inspectors have been proposed in seven provinces. Similarly, there will be 2,257 police sub-inspectors, 5,274 assistant sub-inspectors, 10,611 head constables, 32,888 constables and 1,916 office assistants.

There will be one IGP, five AIGs, 27 DIGs and 58 SSPs in Nepal Police.

The posts of 101 SPs, 272 DSPs, and 756 inspectors have been maintained.

The Headquarters has proposed to give incentive of five grades to the policemen undergoing adjustment in the province. However, there is a provision to add just two grades in the Police Adjustment Act, said the Headquarters.

Probe Panel on Ncell shares...

The government on last December 7 had formed the probe committee under coordination of former Auditor General Sharma to investigate into the issues of compliance with existing laws regarding the decision of Ncell share sale and purchase, revenue and possible impacts in foreign investment.

Secretary of the government of Nepal, Phanindra Gautam, Joint-Secretary of the Finance Ministry, Ritesh Kumar Shakya, Joint-Secretary of the Ministry of Communications and Information Technology, Baburam Bhandari, and President of ICAN, Sujan Kumar Kafle, were the committee members.

Although one-month timeline was given to the probe committee to submit the report, the deadline was extended after the committee failed to complete the task within deadline.

Dignitaries extol martyrs'...

"Realising this spirit of constitution and federal republic to achieve the lasting peace, good governance, development and prosperity will be the only true tribute to our martyrs," the President said.

Likewise, in his message Vice President Ramsahay Prasad Yadav said that only by realizing their dreams, we will be paying true tribute to the martyrs.

Likewise, NC President Deuba in his message urged one and all to make resolutions to transform the dreams of the martyrs into reality by forgetting trivial differences to safeguard the nation and democracy on the occasion of Martyrs Day.

Meanwhile, a memorial meeting was held at Sobha Bhagwati, the place where Martyrs Gangalal Shrestha and Dasthrath Chandra attained immortality.

On the occasion, Kathmandu Metropolitan City Deputy Mayor Sunita Dangol and other officials paid a heartfelt tribute to the martyrs.

Deputy Mayor Dangol said that the stories of the contribution of the martyrs should be handed to the next generations. She said, "Today, the generations of grandparents and parents are present here.

Next year, let's meet with the children and grandchildren. We need to make the new generation known about the sacrifices of the martyrs for the freedom of people and country."

Civil Aviation Authority of Nepal
Corporate Planning and Monitoring Department
Sinamangal, Kathmandu, Nepal

Letter of Intent

Date of Publication: January 30, 2024

Pursuant to the clause 27 (2) of Public Procurement Act, 2063, this is to notify all the bidders that the following substantially responsive lowest evaluated bid has been selected to award the contract as per the Invitation for Bids published on The Rising Nepal dated July-09, 2023.

Name of Contract: Supply, Installation and Commissioning of HCI Solution and Networking Solution (NCB-02-CPMD-2079/80). **Name & Address of Selected Bidder:** M/S Max-Nextgen J.V., Kathmandu. **Bid Amount:** NPR 15,31,75,703.60 (Including VAT)

Former PM Oli doing a film

BY A STAFF REPORTER
Kathmandu, Jan.29



Former Prime Minister and UML chairman KP Sharma Oli is all set to act in the film 'Nametine Ghau.'

The film was announced, and the auspicious event for the film took place on Sunday in the presence of former PM Oli.

Along with Oli, Gyanendra Shahi spokesperson for Rastriya Prajatantra Party, CPN (UML) lawmaker Sunita Baral, artists Ramesh Upreti, Dhiren Shakya, Nirmal Sharma, Bikrant Basnet, and comedian Himesh Panta were present at the auspicious event.

On the occasion of the 'auspicious event' of the film, Oli directed the first scene of the film as well.

The film 'Nametine Ghau' a biopic directed by actor Ramit Dhungana.

Produced under the banner of Ramit Dhungana Film Production, the film will narrate the stories of 33 acid attack victims. The screenplay, written by Shivam Adhikari, took two and a half years to develop.

The film will feature both familiar faces like Surbir Pandit and Ramchandra Adhikari, as well as new talents in the lead roles.

Muskaan Khatun, Simran Khadka, Supragya Sharma, Eva Giri, Prati Paudel, Sanjog Rasaili, Sandeep Babu Lohani, Rachna Gautam, Prabhat Pal Thakuri, Aarti Acharya, Akhil Bajgain and others will be acting in the film.

Addressing the issue of acid attacks, Oli expressed his concern during the event, emphasising the need to end such incidents.

He highlighted the societal preference for superficial beauty and urged people to recognise the importance of inner beauty and behaviour. The film aims to raise awareness about acid attacks, depicting them as heinous crimes, he added.

Director Dhungana said that the film would be shot at locations where the actual acid attacks occurred.

The film unit has planned to shoot the film in Kathmandu, Bhaktapur, Banepa, Panauti, Nawalpur, Pokhara, Birgunj, and Chandrapur in Rautahat, Dhungana added.

Oli also posted on Facebook, "Actor Ramit Dhungana is making a film titled 'Nametine Ghau' to raise public awareness against acid attacks. Acid attack victims are also acting in the film. I had an opportunity to participate in the auspicious occasion of the film along with those victims. I recalled the moment when the law was enacted to control crimes against humanity like acid attacks. I was the prime minister at that time. Today, they proposed that I should play the role of the Prime Minister in the film as well. I agreed."

Art Workshop on 'Sacrifice of Martyrs in Nation Building' begins

BY A STAFF REPORTER
Kathmandu, Jan. 29



In commemoration of 'Martyrs Day 2080', an art workshop focusing on the 'Sacrifice of Martyrs in Nation Building' began at the Nepal Academy of Fine Arts on Monday.

The artworks crafted during the workshop will be showcased at the gallery of the academy from January 30 to February 5.

The Chancellor of the Academy, Naradamani Hartamchhali, highlighted the significance of remembering the contribution of martyrs to society and nation-building through the workshop.

He emphasised, "The workshop aims to vividly portray the invaluable contributions of the martyrs through artistic creations." The former Chancellor of the Academy, KK Karmacharya, expressed the opinion that the substantial contributions and sacrifices of the martyrs have ushered in radical changes in the country.

Highlighting the importance of the workshop, Karmacharya said that the workshop will serve to etch in the memories of future generations the sacrifices made by the martyrs for the country."

Sanjay Bantawa Rai, the head of the contemporary painting department, conveyed the idea of using art from the workshop to perpetuate the memory of martyrs' sacrifices for nation-building.

Artists, including Bhim Bahadur Shrestha, Renuka Maharjan, Surem Deshar, Bibek Mukarung, Chandra Shrestha, Leeladhar KC, Palsangmo Lama, Dineshwor Mahato, Sanjay Bantawa, Aruna Hingmang, Sangi Shrestha, Jupiter Pradhan, Rakesh Chandra Shrestha, Dipendraman Banepali, Kishore Nakarmi, Keshav Raj Khanal, and others are participating in the workshop.

Cultural identity of Jajarkot fading away



BY BASHUDEV SHARMA
Jajarjot, Jan. 29

The unique cultural identity of Jajarkot is under threat as the young generation is becoming disconnected from its roots. In a bid to preserve their cultural identity, Jajarkot Heritage Conservation Foundation on its second anniversary recently presented folk songs and dances in all seven local levels of the district.

Janak KC, President of Jajakot Heritage Conservation Foundation, said, " The unique art and culture of Jajarkot is fading away, so there is a need to conserve our art, artefacts, culture, tradition, folk music and dance. On the second anniversary of Jajarkot Heritage Conservation Foundation, we appeal to all the technology-friendly young generations to promote their art and culture."

Sigaru dance of Bheri Municipality, Khando dance of Kushe Rural Municipality, Deuda of Junichande Rural Municipality, Khayali dance of Nalgada Municipality, Maruni dance of Shivalaya Rural Municipality, Dari, Lahare and Paisseri of Barekot Rural Municipality, Mayur dance of Chhedagada Municipality were performed in the programme.

Gorakh Bahadur Singh, principal of the Birendra Aishwarya Secondary School of Barekot Rural Municipality, said that the performed folk dances and songs made him nostalgic and reminded him of his duty to preserve and promote them so that the coming generation would feel proud of their unique identity.

Rajendra Bikram Shah, leader of civil society, said that the responsibility of exploring their art and culture has fallen on the shoulder of the younger generation, so, such kinds of programmes need to be organised regularly.

Deuda song, Durbar painting, an Agriculture Fair, an industrial exhibition and a public speaking competition on the topic Reconstruction of Heritage Damaged by the Earthquake were organised in the programme.

The local produce such as vegetables, honey, grains, fruits, handmade Nepali paper, clothes and various other handicrafts items were put on exhibition.

Maya Prasad Sharma, a member of the National Assembly, said that the government was determined to conserve their cultural heritage, and urged artists of Jajarkot to promote their folk songs and dances in the national and international arena.

X pauses Taylor Swift searches as deepfake explicit images spread

AP
Los Angeles, Jan. 29



Elon Musk's social media platform X has blocked searches for Taylor Swift as pornographic deepfake images of the singer have circulated online.

Attempts to search for her name on the site resulted in an error message and a prompt for users to retry their search, which added, "Don't fret — it's not your fault."

Searches for variations of her name such as "taylorswift" and "Taylor Swift AI" turned up the same error messages.

Sexually explicit and abusive fake images of Swift began circulating widely last week on X, making her the most famous victim of a scourge that tech platforms and anti-abuse groups have struggled to fix.

"This is a temporary action and done with an abundance of caution as we prioritize safety on this issue," Joe Benarroch, head of business operations at X, said in a statement to multiple news outlets.

After the images began spreading online, the singer's devoted fanbase of "Swifties" quickly mobilized, launching a counter-offensive on X and a #ProtectTaylorSwift hashtag to flood it with more positive images of the pop star. Some said they were reporting accounts that were sharing the deepfakes.

The deepfake-detecting group Reality Defender said it tracked a deluge of nonconsensual pornographic material depicting Swift, particularly on X. Some images also made their way to Meta-owned Facebook and other social media platforms.

The researchers found at least a couple dozen unique AI-generated images. The most widely shared were football-related, showing a painted or bloodied Swift that objectified her and in some cases inflicted violent harm on her deepfake persona.

Researchers have said the number of explicit deepfakes have grown in the past few years, as the technology used to produce such images has become more accessible and easier to use.

In 2019, a report released by the AI firm DeepTrace Labs showed these images were overwhelmingly weaponized against women. Most of the victims, it said, were Hollywood actors and South Korean K-pop singers.

HOROSCOPE

tarot.com

Aries: Your feelings run deep. These sensations are frequently sparked by other people -- whether these people are close to you or further out in your community, they're causing you to feel strongly.

Taurus: Deep connections are built here and now. Perhaps you're bonding with someone on a level that you've never reached with them before. Even if your first impression wasn't great, the more.

Gemini: Your inner life is blooming. You may have felt like you've been operating in the dark or struggling to cling to whatever comes your way, but you may begin to feel more spiritual peace and calm without having to strive with such desperation.

Cancer: Your boundaries matter! Think back on any concessions that you made for certain people, whether you cared about them so much that you let them cross your boundaries or you just didn't want to rock the boat and so repressed your own desires.

Leo: You're showing off who you can be when you're given the chance to perform. Whether you're making a great first impression on an acquaintance or you're showing a new boss that you can be the person to elevate a position.

Virgo: You're expanding your horizons. Whether this means that you're traveling, studying, or reading a book that's opening your mind, you are absolutely refusing to stagnate. Life might have been more boring lately, and you're ready to leave behind your typical walls!

Libra: You're making investments that will pay off. These may be investments in your finances, health, home, or even in your relationship. You're likely thinking about the future, and you want to make sure.

Scorpio: Your fortune appears through other people today. No matter how on top of things you normally are, you might feel somewhat confused or lost. Maybe you're in an unfamiliar environment or just not operating.

Sagittarius: Sticking to a routine is potentially the best thing you can do at the moment. You might feel distracted or prone to procrastinating throughout your day, especially when it comes to having fun with your friends.

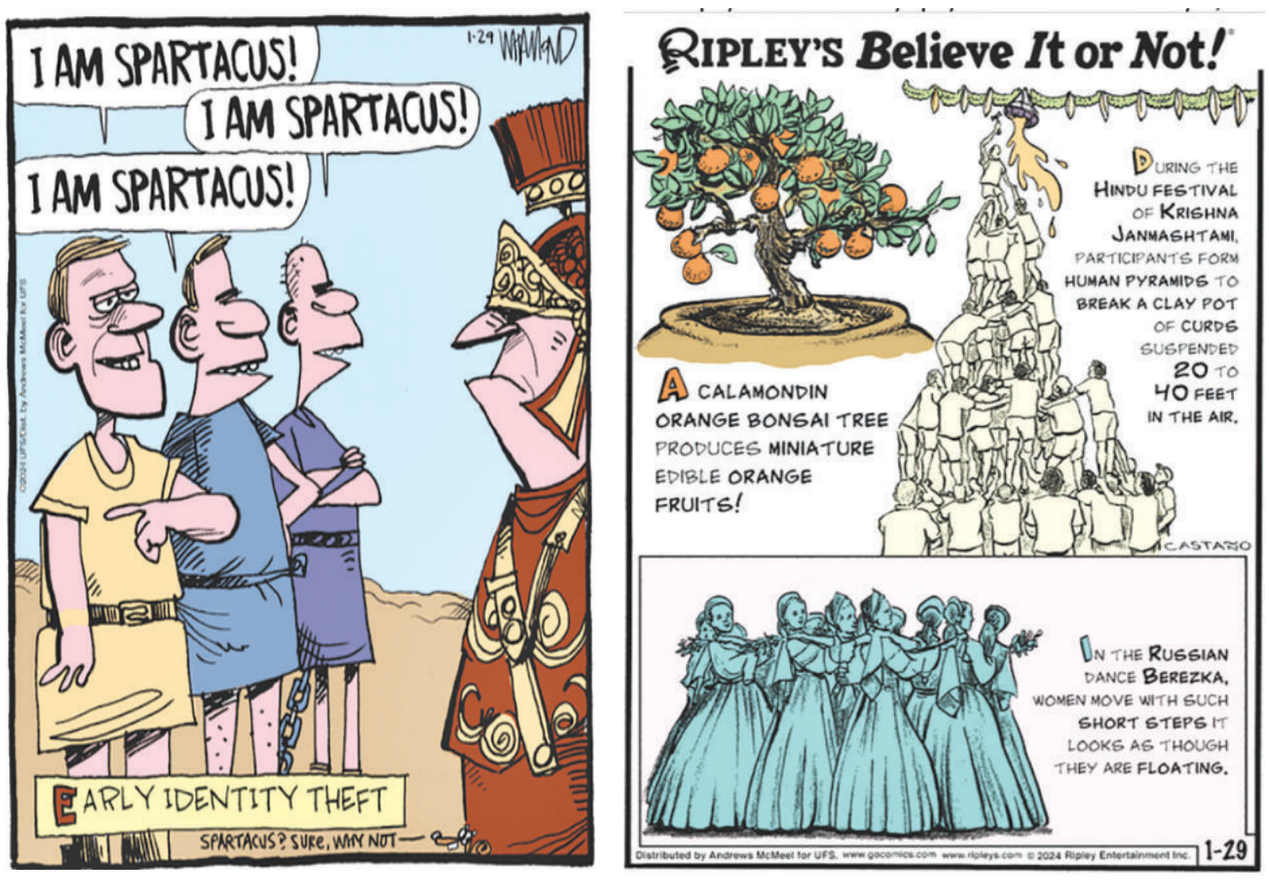
Capricorn: Other people might be taking more notice of you than usual. You may feel like you've been hiding in the background or simply passed over until this moment, but others are possibly approaching you to congratulate you or introduce themselves to you.

Aquarius: Positive change is a real possibility. You may have recently started some healthy habits or dedicated your time to an intriguing project -- you might already be noticing the positive results taking shape in your life.

Pisces: You might have a lot to express. That's understandable -- you've probably got a lot going on that you're willing to chat about! While this isn't a bad thing on its own, you're currently prone to exaggerating.

CARTOON

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Nepal Police marches into PM Cup final

BY A STAFF REPORTER
Kathmandu, Jan. 29

Nepal Police Club secured their place in the final of the Prime Minister (PM) Cup Men's National One Day Cricket Tournament after winning their seventh consecutive match at Upper Mulpani Cricket Ground in Kathmandu on Wednesday.

The Police defeated Gandaki Province by six wickets and qualified for the final with two matches to spare. With seven wins, the Police led the league standings with 14 points.

Tribhuvan Army Club is also on the verge of reaching the final. With one match remaining, the Army has 12 points and is in second place behind the Police. If the Army beats Gandaki Province in their next game, they will qualify for the final. Bagmati Province, which finished third, and Madhes Province, which finished fourth, are out of contention for the top two places after playing all nine matches.

They both have 12 points on the table. Armed Police Force (APF) Club and Sudur Paschim are in fifth and sixth place with eight points, respectively, and still have two matches to play.

At Upper Mulpani, the Police successfully chased the target of 171 runs in 24.2 overs, losing only four wickets. Top scorer Dilip Nath, the opener, scored a quickfire 57 off 39 balls, including four maximums and six boundaries. Arjun Saud, another significant contributor, remained unbeaten on 44 runs off 49 deliveries, including five boundaries and one six. Aarif Sheikh also contributed with an unbeaten 22-ball 27, including five fours.

Kushal Bhurtel (22) and Shankar Rana (12) were the other two players who scored in double digits for the Police. Amrit Gurung took two wickets, while Bipin Khatri and Kamal Pariyar claimed one wicket each for Gandaki.

Earlier, Gandaki scored 170 runs, losing all their wickets in 38.3 overs, after winning the toss and choosing to bat first. Amrit Gurung scored a half-century knock to help Gandaki post a medium score. Gurung cracked eight fours and two sixes off 39 balls before returning to the pavilion as the last wicket.

Gandaki had a poor start, losing two wickets for 15 runs in 8.1 overs. Despite Sameer Kandel (29 off 59 balls) and Karan Pangeni (30 off 54 balls) trying to steady the innings, Gandaki lost wickets at frequent intervals.

Kamal Pariyar (30 off 26 balls) was another significant contributor to Gandaki. Rashid Khan was the pick of the bowlers for Police, finishing with 5-25 in his six-over spell. Lalit Rajbanshi and Karan KC took two wickets each while bowling for the Police.



PHOTO:BIKAS/TRN

Tribhuvan Army Club's Jitendra Mukhiya (centre) is congratulated by his team mate after taking wicket against Sudur Pashim Province during the PM Cup at TU Cricket Ground, Kirtipur on Monday.

At TU Cricket Ground, Army scored a massive total of 262 runs, losing all their wickets in 48.3 overs after winning the toss and electing to bat first. Sudur Paschim, in reply, were bundled out for 165 runs in 40.1 overs.

Medium pacer Jitendra Mukhiya's miserly spell did the most damage in the dismissal of Sudur Paschim. Mukhiya claimed five wickets, conceding only ten runs while bowling two maiden overs off 37 deliveries.

Kiran Thagunna was the top scorer for Sudur Paschim, scoring 68 runs off 74 balls, including six boundaries and three sixes. Sher Malla (24), Naren Bhatta (18), Prakash Pandey (11), Gajendra Bohara (12), and Narayan Joshi (13) were the other players who scored in double digits for Sudur Paschim.

Sompal Kami also took two wickets but gave away 46 runs. Shahab Alam, Kushal Malla, and Basir Ahmed dismissed one batter each for Army.

Despite tottering to 56/4 in 9.6 overs, the lower-order batters rescued Army with their double-digit scores. Opener Santosh Karki (30) and Sandeep Tajali (37) put up some resistance from the top. Basir Ahamad (36), Sompal Kami (31), and Shahab Alam (21) contributed from the lower order. Although Bhoj Raj Bhatta took a wicket haul, he could not stop Army from scoring runs at a rapid pace. Naren Saud also dismissed three batters for Sudur Paschim.

SNIPPETS

Siddartha, Sanjeet win gold



Kathmandu (TRN): Siddartha Lama Tamang and Sanjeet Kumar Rai won gold medals at the Battle of The Dragons Championship held in New Jersey, United States of America on Monday. Siddartha, who is the President of Nepal WUMA Kungfu Association, collected 9.1 points in the Kung Fu Tai Chi category and won a gold medal. He also participated in the Kung Fu Weapon category and won a silver medal with 8.7 points. Siddartha is an international judge of WUMA Kung Fu. Sanjeet, on the other hand, won a gold medal in the Kung Fu Creative Form category with 8.0 points. He is also an international judge and a senior vice president of Nepal WUMA Kung Fu. The tournament was held from January 26-28 in New Jersey. After the victory, President Siddartha expressed his satisfaction with the exceptional achievement of winning a gold medal.

Jawalakhel shoots out Manang

Kathmandu (TRN): Jawalakhel Youth Club defeated Manang Marsyangdi Club 7-6 in sudden death to progress into the semifinals of the Aaha! Rara Pokhara Gold Cup on Monday. After the regulation 90 minute and extra time ended in 1-1 tie, the match was decided from penalty shootout. The tie-breaker also finished in 4-4 draw. Jawalakhel, however, achieved the victory in sudden death as its goalkeeper Anish Deula stopped the ninth penalty from Randip Paudel of Manang. Hisub Thapaliya put Jawalakhel ahead in the 55th minute and Manang restored the parity in 89th minute from Rajesh Pariyar's goal. The added 30 minutes could not decide the match as no goal was possible. The last quarterfinal match will be played between First division league champions Church Boys United Club and Nepal Police Club on Tuesday.

Inter move back to top

Milan (AP): It seems as if no one can stop Inter Milan or Lautaro Martínez. The Argentina World Cup winner scored again Sunday to help Inter to a 1-0 win at Fiorentina, which had a penalty saved. Inter moved back to the top of Serie A and with a game in hand, after its involvement in the Italian Super Cup in Saudi Arabia. Simone Inzaghi's side leapfrogged a point above second-place Juventus, which was held to a 1-1 draw at home to Empoli on Saturday. Lazio and Napoli played out a tense 0-0 draw that did neither side any favors in their fight for fourth spot in Serie A. Both teams were looking to bounce back from losses in the Italian Super Cup. Lazio was humiliated 3-0 by Inter in the semifinals, while Napoli lost 1-0 to the Nerazzurri in the final.

NEPAL TO FACE BANGLADESH, INDIA IN SUPER SIX OF U19 WC

BY A STAFF REPORTER
Kathmandu, Jan. 29

Nepal will take on Bangladesh and India in the Super Six stage of the ICC U19 Men's Cricket World Cup 2024.

Following the conclusion of the last round of group stage matches on Sunday, the fixtures in the Super Six stage were confirmed. The Super Six fixtures will take place from Tuesday, January 30 to Saturday, February 3.

Nepali young guns will face Bangladesh to open their Super Six stage on January 31 (Wednesday). The second match of Nepal will be against India U19 team set on February 2.

According to the International Cricket Council (ICC), the top three teams in Groups A and D combine, as well as the top three sides in Groups B and C, creating two groups of six where the top two sides in each will progress to the semi-finals.

India and Pakistan topped Groups A and D respectively, and they will be joined by fellow qualifiers Bangladesh, Ireland, Nepal and New Zealand to form the first group.

The second group will feature the top teams in Groups B and C – South Africa and Australia – joined by England, Sri Lanka, West Indies and Zimbabwe.

Teams carry points, wins & net run rate earned against their fellow qualifying teams into their respective Super Six groups, and will each play two further matches before the semi-finalists are determined.

Liverpool advances in FA Cup

AP
London, Jan. 29

It was business as usual for Liverpool in its first game since Jurgen Klopp announced his shock decision to walk away at the end of the season.

The Merseyside club advanced to the fifth round of the FA Cup after a 5-2 win against second-tier Norwich on Sunday.

How Klopp would love to end his trophy-laden reign on a winning note by guiding Liverpool to more silverware this year. And victory at Anfield kept alive his team's four-pronged trophy pursuit, having already secured a place in League Cup final this week.Liverpool also tops the Premier League and is in the knockout stage of the Europa League.

The cup represents Erik ten Hag's last realistic chance of a trophy in his second season at the club and it took second-half goals from Antony and Rasmus Hojlund to secure the Premier League team's place in the next round.

United had quickly raced in front through goals from Bruno Fernandes in the seventh minute and Kobbie Mainoo in the 13th.

But Ten Hag's team was shocked when Bryn Morris pulled one back with a deflected long shot in the 36th. And it took only two minutes of the second half for Will Evans to slide in an equalizer.

But when Luke Shaw's curling shot hit the post, Antony was quick to react and converted the rebound from an angle in the 68th.

Hojlund made certain of the win in the fourth minute of stoppage time.

United will play Bristol City or Nottingham Forest in the next round.

Wolves won the heated West Midlands derby 2-0, but the result was overshadowed by scenes off the field at the Hawthorns and the lengthy delay until the game could be restarted.

Girona reclaims 1st place

There's no easing off for Girona in the Spanish league. The Catalan club rebounded from a setback in the Copa del Rey by beating Celta Vigo 1-0 in the league on Sunday to extend its impressive run and return to the top of the standings.

Portu scored a first-half winner to move Girona a point ahead of Real Madrid, which won 2-1 at Las Palmas on Saturday. Madrid has played one game less than Girona.

"This is a long-distance race," Girona coach Míchel Sánchez said. "We are in a very nice position and we want to continue this run."

Girona has 17 wins in 22 league matches, and the competition's best attack with 52 goals. No other team has scored more than 45.

Míchel's team has won six of its last eight league games, but it has a tough stretch ahead with matches against sixth-place Real Sociedad, second-place Madrid and fifth-place Athletic Bilbao. Atletico Madrid moved past Barcelona into third place by beating Valencia 2-0 with a goal in each half by Samuel Lino and Memphis Depay.

The victory extended Atletico's unbeaten run at home to 27 matches, since a 1-0 loss to Barcelona in January last year. It has only two draws during that streak, which ties its unbeaten run at home achieved from 2019-2021.

Sevilla's struggles continued with its home draw against Osasuna, which left the team one point outside the relegation zone and prompted more jeers from its fans.

Sevilla has only one win in its last 16 league games and was coming off elimination against Atletico in the quarterfinals of the Copa del Rey.



WEATHER

Tuesday

Sunrise at 6:52 am, Sunset at 5:42 pm

Forecast for Nepal (Tuesday)

Partly to generally cloudy in the hilly areas of the country and partly cloudy to mainly fair in the rest of the country. Chances of light snowfall at one or two places of the high hilly and mountainous region of Koshi Province, Bagmati Province, Gandaki Province and Karnali Province.

Expected Temp.: 16-18 Rain Probability: 0%

Monday's Weather Record

Stations	Max. temp. (C)	Min. temp. (C)	Rain (mm)
Dadeldhura	15.0	2.7	0.0
Dipayal	22.5	2.9	0.0
Dhangadi	23.0	4.5	0.0
Birendranagar	22.2	3.3	0.0
Nepalgunj	22.9	6.5	0.0
Jumla	16.0	-4.5	0.0
Ghorahi	21.3	5.5	0.0
Pokhara	20.1	6.2	0.0
Bhairahawa	21.7	4.0	0.0
Simara	20.8	3.5	0.0
Kathmandu	18.5	3.0	0.0
Okhaldhunga	16.8	6.3	0.0
Taplejung	15.7	5.0	0.0
Dhankuta	21.0	6.8	0.0
Biratnagar	23.6	5.4	0.0
Jomsom	8.1	-3.5	0.0*
Dharan	23.9	11.3	0.0*
Lumle	14.6	3.8	0.0*
Janakpur	24.0	5.0	0.0*
Jiri	14.1	-1.2	0.0*

NEPAL RASTRA BANK

FOREIGN EXCHANGE DEPARTMENT

EXCHANGE RATES

January 30, 2024

CURRENCY	UNIT	BUYING	SELLING
Indian Rupee	100	Rs. 160.00	Rs. 160.15

Open Market Exchange Rates
For the purpose of Nepal Rastra Bank

CURRENCY	UNIT	BUYING	SELLING
U.S. Dollar	1	Rs. 132.72	Rs. 133.32
Euro	1	Rs. 143.59	Rs. 144.24
Pound Sterling	1	Rs. 168.57	Rs. 169.33
Swiss Franc	1	Rs. 153.79	Rs. 154.48
Australian Dollar	1	Rs. 87.62	Rs. 88.02
Canadian Dollar	1	Rs. 98.80	Rs. 99.24
Singapore Dollar	1	Rs. 98.92	Rs.99.36
Japanese Yen	10	Rs. 8.98	Rs. 9.02
Chinese Yuan	1	Rs. 18.48	Rs. 18.56
Saudi Arab Riyal	1	Rs. 35.39	Rs. 35.55
Qatari Riyal	1	Rs. 36.40	Rs. 36.57
Thai Bhat	1	Rs. 3.73	Rs. 3.75
UAE Dirham	1	Rs. 36.13	Rs. 36.30
Malaysian Ringgit	1	Rs. 28.04	Rs. 28.16
South Korean Won	100	Rs. 9.93	Rs. 9.97
Swedish Kronar	1	Rs. 12.67	Rs. 12.72
Danish Kronar	1	Rs. 19.26	Rs. 19.35
Hong Kong Dollar	1	Rs. 16.99	Rs. 17.06
Kuwaiti Dinar	1	Rs. 431.33	Rs. 433.28
Bahrain Dinar	1	Rs. 352.05	Rs. 353.64

Note: Under the present system the open market exchange rates quoted by different banks may differ.

Jordan score twice at the death to surge into Asian Cup last eight

AFP
Doha, Jan. 29

Jordan will meet tournament debutants Tajikistan in the Asian Cup quarter-finals after scoring twice in three minutes deep in stoppage time to stun Iraq 3-2 in a thriller on Monday.

Lower-ranked Jordan looked down and out heading into injury time at the end of the game only for Yazan Al-Arab to prod in for a 95th-minute leveller. If that was hard to believe, better was to come two minutes later when Nizar Al-Rashdan curled in from distance to fire Jordan into the last eight.

Iraq were left heartbroken and shell-shocked, having gone into the dying minutes dreaming of repeating their fairytale 2007 Asian Cup title triumph.

Jordan face a Tajikistan side in the last eight who are one of the shocks of the competition on their debut. Jordan were the underdogs and ranked 24 places lower than Iraq but were the better side in an eventful first half.

Midway through the first period striker Ali Olwan was denied when he shot straight at Jalal Hassan with only the Iraqi goalkeeper to beat. The stopper had to be alert on another occasion, rushing out of his box to bravely head the ball away from danger as a Jordan attacker bore down.



In front of a raucous crowd at the 45,000-capacity Khalifa International Stadium, Iraqi midfielder Ibrahim Bayesh stung the fingertips of goalkeeper Yazeed Abulaila from outside the box.

Seven minutes from the break, Jordan -- who held South Korea 2-2 in the group phase -- manufactured another opportunity when Mousa Al-Tamari bustled his way through the Iraqi defence. The Montpellier attacker outmuscled two defenders but again found goalkeeper Hassan in the way.

In the first minute of injury time Jordan deservedly took the lead. The Iraq defence sloppily presented Yazan Al-Naimat with the ball and he raced towards goal before chipping over a flailing and overworked Hassan.

Iraq, who defeated pre-tournament favourites Japan 2-1 in the group stage, went on the attack after the break. Abulaila denied Bayesh with another spectacular save but Iraq's pressure paid off in the 68th minute when defender Saad Natiq nodded down and in from a corner for the equaliser.

Jordan went right up the other end and flashed an effort across goal, before Aymen Hussein controlled the ball unmarked in the box and thrashed for 2-1 and what he thought was Iraq's winner in the 76th minute.

It was his sixth goal of the tournament but he was promptly given a second yellow card for over-celebrating and sent off.

Then came Jordan's quickfire double at the death to leave Iraq reeling.

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